

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called Instructions on the Great Vehicle

Āryamahāyānopadeśanāma mahāyānasūtra · Toh 169 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཐག་པ་ཆན་པའི་མན་ངག་ཅས་བརྒྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆན་པའི་མན་

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called "Instructions on the Great Vehicle," known in Sanskrit as the Āryamahāyānopadeśa and in Tibetan as Pakpa Tekpa Chenpo'i Men Ngak (པཀ་ཏེ་པ་ཅེན་པོའི་མན་ངག་), is a Mahāyāna sūtra presenting the Buddha's teachings on the path and practices of the Great Vehicle. Set at Rājagṛha in a magnificent celestial assembly hall adorned with precious things and described as the domain of the Tathāgatas, the text opens with an elaborate evocation of a sacred space perfected through the merit and miraculous powers of the buddhas, suggesting a discourse of considerable scope directed toward bodhisattvas and great beings. It is Toh 169 in the Kangyur, catalogued among the Mahāyāna sūtras, and its organization into fascicles indicates it is a text of substantial length.

In the language of India: Āryamahāyānopadeśanāma mahāyānasūtra.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle called "Instructions on the Great Vehicle."

First fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was at Rājagṛha, in the cloister of the assembly adorned with precious things, the domain of the Tathāgatas, the abode of the Tathāgatas — a place where the great adornments of merit had been gathered together, fitting as a support for the great conduct, perfectly accomplished through the karmic maturation of all the Dharmas of a buddha, where the dwelling places of the bodhisattvas, the great beings, are shown without limit, blessed by the miraculous powers of the Tathāgatas, generating vast delight in entering the wisdom of the domain free from attachment, entered through mindfulness, intelligence, and realization, in no way subject to reproach, entered through realization that is not attached to what is analytically discerned by wisdom, praised throughout endless aeons, abiding in the immeasurable accumulation of all qualities.

The Blessed One had fully and completely awakened to the equality of all phenomena, had turned the wheel of Dharma to its utmost, had gathered a

retinue of disciples supremely well-tamed and without limit, had obtained mastery over all phenomena, knew supremely well the inclinations of all sentient beings, had attained the supreme perfection of the faculties, and was skilled in utterly subduing all the habitual tendencies of the afflictions of all sentient beings. The spontaneously accomplished activities of all the buddhas continued without interruption.

Together with a great Saṅgha of six hundred thousand monks — and every one of them was an arhat, with defilements exhausted, without afflictions, possessed of mastery, supremely liberated in mind, supremely liberated in wisdom, knowing well, great as elephants, their task accomplished, their work done, their burden laid down, their own aim fully attained, their bondage to existence completely exhausted, the mind supremely liberated through right knowledge, having reached the supreme perfection of all mental powers, having utterly vanquished all the habitual tendencies and bonds of the afflictions, skilled in abiding in the profound Dharma as sons of the Tathāgata, the king of Dharma, arisen from the sphere of the non-apprehensible, of beautiful conduct, fully accomplished, become a great field of generosity, entirely devoted to the word of the Tathāgatas.

Together also with a great assembly of bodhisattvas — bodhisattvas, great beings, immeasurable in number, uncountable, inconceivable, unequalled, immeasurable beyond reckoning, inexpressible — every one of them skilled in traversing limitless buddha-fields in a single instant of mind, devoted without tiring to making offerings and paying homage to the Tathāgatas, to hearing the Dharma and grasping it rightly, and continuously and without interruption to fully ripening all sentient beings, abiding perfectly in the unobstructed liberation that has reached the supreme perfection of skillful means and wisdom, utterly transcending all thought, conceptual thought, and conceptual elaboration, and every one of them drawn very close to the ground of omniscience. Among them were: the bodhisattva, the great being, called Lightning; Victorious in Battle; Essence of Vairocana; Courageous in Subduing; Vanquisher of All Doubts; Endowed with Wide Proclamation; the Eye of Vision; and the bodhisattva, the great being, called Free from the Mass of Darkness — and so on, bodhisattvas, great beings, immeasurable, uncountable, inconceivable, unequalled, immeasurable beyond reckoning.

— and together with the inexpressible ones.

Then the Blessed One, with decisive entry into the conduct of a bodhisattva, focused upon the category of Dharma called the Gateway of Unobscured Entry, which sets out the bodhisattva's path: the profound qualities of a buddha; the complete accomplishment of powers and fearlessness; the source of primordial wisdom; entry through the seal of dhāraṇī that has mastery over all phenomena; entry through the gateway of determination within the individual perfect knowledges; penetrating absorption into the primordial wisdom of the great higher knowledges; teaching non-arising to the irreversible assembly; perfect gathering into the single vehicle; the dharmadhātu as one nature — entry into that which is unmixed; entry into the intentions and faculties of all sentient beings; teaching, full of essence, the Dharma without uncertainty; demolishing every maṇḍala of māra; penetrating absorption into entry upon the mode of Dharma as it truly is; taming all afflictions and every kind of wrong view, following unobstructed wisdom and primordial wisdom; teaching the primordial wisdom of skillful means expert in dedication that is peerless and boundless; following entry into knowing all the qualities of a buddha as equal; entry into the primordial wisdom of all buddhas; entry through the gateway of unobstructed blessing, teaching all phenomena with unfailing certainty just as they are; entering into equanimity in non-thought and non-conceptual thought, penetrating absorption into the profound dependent origination, and gathering all accumulations of merit and primordial wisdom and so forth; adorned with the adornment of the equanimity of the body, speech, and mind of a buddha; manifestly accomplishing inexhaustible mindfulness, intelligence, conviction, realization, and wisdom; entering upon the mode of the noble truths in order to tame those to be tamed by the śrāvaka vehicle; knowing the profound solitude of body and mind in order to tame those to be tamed by the pratyekabuddha vehicle; receiving the empowerment upon the ground of the primordial wisdom of omniscience in order to tame those to be tamed by the Great Vehicle — in order to proclaim the qualities of the Tathāgata, he spoke of entry upon the mode of having mastery over all phenomena, taught it and taught it fully, led beings into holding it, inspired aspiration for it, led them into taking it up, caused them to know it, caused them to understand it, caused them to know it thoroughly, led them fully into it, explained it, distinguished it, made it clear, and taught it perfectly and completely.

Then, as the Blessed One was thus teaching this category of Dharma in such breadth and with utter unfailing certainty, there was in that very assembly a

girl called Precious Jewel who was seated there. She rose from her seat, took up a pearl garland in her right hand, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

Blessed One, by whatever truth and truthful words by which these great sentient beings will come to hold this chapter gathering the category of Dharma that has been taught, and will spread it throughout the ten directions, and the unsurpassable Jewel of Dharma will in due course place immeasurable sentient beings upon unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening — by that truth and by those truthful words, I now offer this pearl garland to the Tathāgata. And may that offering, in whatever manner a palace built of pearl garlands abides and is arrayed upon the crown of the head of each of those noble ones — the Tathāgata and all the bodhisattvas — bring it about that those holy beings perfectly and manifestly attain awakening.

May those bodhisattvas behold from those palace towers the splendid array of qualities of a buddha-field — an array exactly like this — and be filled with delight, and may the entire retinue, upon seeing this arrangement, be gladdened.

Then the maiden Precious Jewel cast that pearl garland in the direction of the Blessed One. The very instant the pearl garland was cast, by the power of the Buddha and by the blessing of the truthful words of the maiden Precious Jewel, a great palace tower of immense breadth and vast extent, beautifully luminous, lovely to behold, with walls perfectly smooth and even, superbly well-constructed, came to rest upon the crown of the Blessed One's head and upon the crown of the head of every bodhisattva. And from those palace towers those bodhisattvas also beheld arrangements corresponding exactly to the distinctive character of the aspirations they had made — aspirations such as "May we have a buddha-field with qualities arrayed in just such a way! May our seat of awakening be just such as this!" And having seen it, they were filled with wonder, and they addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, how remarkable it is that everything we have assembled through aspirations made throughout countless eons was shown to the maiden Precious Jewel in a single instant. Truly, this maiden Precious Jewel is possessed of the power of the blessing of truth."

The Blessed One declared: "It is so. Just as these noble ones have said — this maiden Precious Jewel has arisen definitively from the blessing of truth. Noble ones, the maiden Precious Jewel, having cultivated roots of virtue in the

presence of ninety-six hundred trillion buddhas and having fully taken up this blessing of truth, has since abided in accordance with every word she spoke."

If the maiden Precious Jewel were to say, "May this entire perfect trichiliocosm be thoroughly filled with flowers," it would come to pass exactly so. In the same way, if she were to say, "May it be thoroughly filled with incense, garlands, perfume, powder, and cloth," it would likewise come to pass. If she were to say, "May all of this sky be adorned with parasols, victory banners, and pennants," that too would come to pass exactly so. If at a time when a world is being destroyed by water she were to say, "May it be destroyed by fire instead," that would come to pass. If at a time when a world is being destroyed by fire she were to say, "May it be destroyed by water instead," that too would come to pass. If she were to say, "May this entire perfect retinue take on the color and form of a wheel-turning king," that would come to pass. In the same way, if she were to say, "May they take on the color and form of a guardian of the world (a lokapāla), or the color and form of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), or of Brahmā, or of the Great Lord (Maheśvara), or the color and form of a monk, a nun, a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner," all of that would likewise come to pass. If even for each and every māra, with each leading more than a hundred million māra armies bearing weapons in hand — if regarding all the swords, short spears, arrows, double-pointed weapons, and various other weapons of those māras and of every class of māra she were to say, "May all of these abide as pearl garlands adorned with various precious stones," and further, "May they become saffron flowers, blue utpala lotuses, pāriṣkā flowers, and

campaka flowers spreading everywhere" — all of that would likewise come to pass. If in wild and deserted places without food, drink, or provisions, where great cities of eighty million households have come to dwell, she were to say, "May abundant food, drink, and provisions appear" — that too would come to pass just so. If throughout the world-realm of the great trichiliocosm she were to say, "May all visible forms that appear there abide as the form of the Tathāgata" — that too would come to pass just so. If she were to say, "May this entire assembly abide in the sky" — that too would come to pass just so.

Sons of good family, if the girl Ratnā were to say, "May all the blessed buddhas teaching the Dharma in boundless and limitless world-realms of the ten directions appear here in this very space, lacking nothing, complete in every particular, endowed with all supreme aspects" — that too would come to pass just so. None of the girl Ratnā's deeds are fruitless in the slightest.

Thereupon, having displayed all of these miraculous powers, the power of truth, the power of supernatural ability, the wondrous transformations and displays of miracles, the girl Ratnā praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses:

Source of jewels, possessing jewel-like wisdom,
displaying supreme jewels, of qualities without limit,
king of kings, severing both foes and their arising,
granting the seven precious jewels of awakening's branches.

The radiance of jewel-light is without bound,
the precious gem radiates colors of every kind.
Supreme jewel, Victor, jewel-crowned crest:
we honor you, O Sugata, with these precious gems.

The essence of rock, the jewel within the earth,
the luminous stainless essence-jewel,
the light of the precious, of sun and moon —
all are dimmed and overcome by the radiance of your body.

To measure the extent of your body, O Sage,
even those dwelling through the ten grounds cannot perceive it.
Yet you, Lord of the World, are known to rest upon the earth,
while your miraculous qualities are seen to dwell at existence's peak.

Each one among all the retinues of Victors
knows its own Victor to be present before it.
From every direction they appear directly,
and from every gate the incomparable one is seen.

Some see you seated, lying down, and walking;
to some among the retinue the Sugata speaks,
to others you sit in silence, delighting in meditative absorption.
Your peerless conduct, O incomparable one, is seen to be without limit.

From every single hair of yours a supreme ray of light
is released, and in an instant fills all ten directions.
The Victor's body is like a source of lotuses,
fulfilling all wishes and delighting the mind.

Abiding in truth, ever rejoicing in truth,
taking truth as your supreme concern — may all you say be so.
Source of Dharma, skilled in meaning and in discipline,

you who have reached the end of all qualities — I bow to you.

Having praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses, the girl Ratnā then addressed the Blessed One, saying: "Blessed One, if the Blessed One would be so gracious as to grant me the opportunity to ask, and then to bestow a prophecy in response to my inquiry, I would compose a short related sequence of teachings on the categories of Dharma of the chapter on the assembly and offer it as a question." The Blessed One declared: "Girl, ask the Tathāgata whatever you wish to ask, and I shall give you a prophecy in response to each of your questions, bringing joy to your mind." Then, the Tathāgata having granted the opening, the girl Ratnā addressed the Blessed One, saying: "Blessed One, what is it that makes bodhisattvas speakers of truth?"

"What is it that the Tathāgata has declared to be truth for bodhisattvas? Blessed One, who are those bodhisattvas who are speakers of Dharma? What is it that the Tathāgata has declared to be Dharma for bodhisattvas? Blessed One, who are those bodhisattvas who are speakers of meaning? What is it that the Tathāgata has declared to be meaning for bodhisattvas? Blessed One, who are those bodhisattvas who are speakers of Vinaya? What is it that the Tathāgata has declared to be Vinaya for bodhisattvas?"

Then the Blessed One bestowed upon the girl Ratnā his approval, saying: "Excellent! Girl, excellent! Excellent! Your understanding is good. Your questions are proper. Your eloquence is wholesome. Therefore, girl, listen well and hold this in mind, for I shall explain it to you." The girl Ratnā replied to the Blessed One, "Excellent, Blessed One," and gave her full attention. Then the Blessed One spoke these words:

"Girl, these three are the truths of a bodhisattva. What are the three? Non-deception toward the buddhas, non-deception toward oneself, and non-deception toward all sentient beings.

"Girl, what does it mean for a bodhisattva to be deceptive toward the buddhas, toward oneself, and toward all sentient beings? Girl, if a bodhisattva has aroused the mind of unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening and yet desires, aspires to, and takes delight in the ground of a śrāvaka or the ground of a pratyekabuddha — that kind of delight, girl, is what it means for a bodhisattva to be deceptive toward the buddhas, toward oneself, and toward all sentient beings.

"Girl, what does it mean for a bodhisattva to be non-deceptive toward the buddhas, toward oneself, and toward all sentient beings? Girl, when a bodhisattva, having aroused the mind of awakening, is assailed and harmed to whatever degree by māras and by all those with fixated aims, when all hostile opponents raise objections and challenge and engage in debate, when pierced with swords, short spears, and double-edged weapons, when deprived of gain, deprived of renown, when blamed, when afflicted with suffering — even then does not waver, does not err, does not fall into confusion, does not shrink, does not become languid, is not frightened at all, is not made fearful at all, is not bewildered, and does not become regretful. Rather, that bodhisattva neither abandons the elevated aspiration held from the very beginning nor loosens the firm, authentic grip upon it. Having aroused the precious awakening mind, having aroused a mind that is supremely exalted above all three worlds, having aroused the mind that is refuge, protector, and ally for all sentient beings, and having aroused a mind that is without equal and without parallel — from that mind the bodhisattva does not decline or fall away. Not even for a moment does the mind arise that desires another vehicle; rather, the bodhisattva is mindful of the buddhas, relies upon the wheel of Dharma, brings all sentient beings to realization, manifests strength, generates power, subjugates through prowess, takes up diligence, and cannot be harmed by the words of opponents. This, girl, is what it means for a bodhisattva to be non-deceptive toward the buddhas, toward oneself, and toward all sentient beings. This non-deception of a bodhisattva toward the buddhas, toward oneself, and toward all sentient beings — this is the supreme truth of a bodhisattva.

"Through four qualities one is non-deceptive toward the buddhas: steadfastness, strength, and the sharpness of diligence. Through four qualities one is non-deceptive toward oneself: sincerity of aspiration, elevation of aspiration, freedom from wavering, and freedom from pretense."

Through four qualities one is non-deceptive toward all sentient beings: engagement, loving-kindness, compassion, and gathering.

Girl, one who does not abandon the awakening mind and does not fall away from one's former vow — this is the first entry into the truth of a bodhisattva.

Girl, furthermore, the truth of a bodhisattva is this: restraint of speech, guarding of speech, freedom from error in speech, and speaking words that are true. Whether alone or dwelling among many people, one speaks words

that are true; not even for the sake of a kingdom does one speak false words; even if enticed by precious gems filling a great trichiliocosm, one does not speak false words.

Girl, in that regard, the truth of a bodhisattva is the complete purity of thirty-two aspects. What are those thirty-two aspects? They are as follows: the aspect of moral shame; the aspect of good qualities; the aspect of conscientious restraint; the aspect of being pleasing; the aspect of being without artifice; the aspect of being without deprecation; the aspect of being unobjectified; the aspect of being known to the gods; the aspect of fearlessness; the aspect of cutting off lower rebirths; the aspect of opening the way to higher rebirths; the aspect of being a source of joy to noble persons; the aspect of being worthy of homage by the wise; the aspect of being inwardly pure; the aspect of being outwardly well-fashioned; the aspect of speech that is worthy of being held in mind; the aspect of speech that is not to be disparaged; the aspect of speech that is gentle; the aspect of speech that is distinguished; the aspect of speech whose fragrance is supremely sweet; the aspect of being easy to trust; the aspect of being without deception; the aspect of being without distress; the aspect of joy and supreme joy; the aspect of being resolved toward oneself; the aspect of being resolved toward others; the aspect of being without confusion; the aspect of being without fault; the aspect of being a ground and basis of giving; the aspect of pleasing the buddhas; and the aspect of fully attaining speech that accords with truth. Girl, these are the thirty-two aspects of the complete purity of truth.

Girl, furthermore, the truth of a bodhisattva is the complete fulfillment of one's vows. Why is that? Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas devoted to generosity, not to the miserly — this is their vow. And the appearance of always giving away all one's possessions entirely — this is their truth.

Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas of completely pure moral discipline, not to those of bad conduct — this is their vow. And the appearance of always upholding completely pure moral discipline — this is their truth.

Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas who fully attain the power of patience, not to those with harmful intent — this is their vow. And the appearance of always abiding in patience and pleasingness — this is their truth.

Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas who arouse diligence, not to the slothful — this is their vow. And the appearance of always striving in all virtuous roots — this is their truth.

Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas who are well established in meditative concentration, not to those with distracted minds — this is their vow. And the appearance of always accomplishing the limbs of meditative concentration perfectly — this is their truth.

Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas endowed with wisdom, not to those of impaired wisdom — this is their vow. And the appearance of always abiding in wisdom and gnosis — this is their truth.

And so on, applying the same pattern as before.

The same pattern applies equally to all the factors conducive to awakening, the four means of gathering disciples, the divine abidings, the supraknowledges, the higher knowledges, calm abiding, and insight.

Awakening belongs to bodhisattvas who are endowed with all virtuous qualities, not to those who have abandoned virtuous qualities — this is their vow. And the appearance of always present in all virtuous qualities — this is their truth.

Dear daughter, beyond this, a bodhisattva must also strive in that noble form of truth which is: knowing suffering, abandoning the origin of suffering, knowing cessation, and cultivating the path.

In that context, knowing suffering means knowing that the aggregates do not arise by intrinsic nature. Abandoning the origin of suffering means that the craving which would properly establish the aggregates in continued existence simply does not arise at all — it is free from attachment, without delight; and that which is without delight has never come from anywhere. That which has never come from anywhere has not abandoned the nature of reality. And from that which has not abandoned the nature of reality, the origin of suffering is abandoned.

Knowing cessation in that context means the thorough exhaustion and cessation of signs and referential objects. At the time of that cessation, no existing thing is destroyed either; and seeing with equanimity all phenomena in which having things and not having things are equal and equivalent — this is called the truth of cessation.

The path in that context is: viewing with equanimity and engaging with equanimity, not conceptualizing, not bearing the defining mark of inequality, not seeking out any affliction whatsoever, without self, without grasping, without taking up, unmade, unconditioned — this is what is called the path.

Herein, the gnosis that knows the truths, and yet which, while bringing sentient beings to genuine attainment, does not actualize anything for oneself — this too is called the truth of a bodhisattva.

When this teaching on the truths was spoken, the bodhisattva Khri attained the forbearance of fully cultivating the knowledge of the truths.

Dear daughter, how then is a bodhisattva one who speaks the Dharma? It is when one turns to the Dharma as one's refuge, speaks the Dharma, thinks the Dharma, reflects on the Dharma, has the Dharma as one's sphere of activity, practices the Dharma, pursues the Dharma, desires the Dharma, is joyfully devoted through delight in the Dharma, bears the banner of the Dharma, holds the victory-crest of the Dharma, wields the weapon of the Dharma, dons the armor of the Dharma, puts on the provisions of the Dharma, is illumined by the light of the Dharma, bears the lamp of the Dharma, holds mindfulness of the Dharma, possesses the intelligence of the Dharma, investigates the Dharma, analyzes the Dharma, engages in the Dharma, conducts oneself in the Dharma, rests in the Dharma, walks the path of the Dharma, guards the Dharma, has the Dharma as one's wealth, finds the Dharma inexhaustible, finds the Dharma vast, performs the activity of the Dharma, and does not abandon body of the Dharma, speech of the Dharma, and mind devoted to the Dharma. One who is endowed with such conduct of the Dharma is one who speaks the Dharma — not one who speaks what is not the Dharma.

And what is speaking the Dharma? It is speaking what is true as true, speaking in praise of the Buddha, speaking in protection of the Dharma, speaking of revering and attending upon the Saṅgha, speaking to inspire devotion to the awakening mind, speaking of not abandoning one's intention, speaking of holding the object of supreme intention, speaking of not letting one's engagement decline, speaking the view of the noble ones, speaking of relying upon spiritual friends, speaking of reverence combined with freedom from pride, speaking of always offering praise, speaking equanimously while one is established in dignity when teaching the Dharma, speaking of being insatiable in seeking the Dharma everywhere, speaking of having no laziness in teaching the Dharma,

speaking of a teacher having no concealment of the Dharma, of repaying kindness, of knowing what has been done for one, of not wasting what has been done, speaking of expecting nothing in return, speaking of having no fear in solitary places, speaking of not letting the noble lineage decline, speaking of

not abandoning the qualities one has trained in, speaking of entering the path of the ten virtuous actions of karma, speaking in praise of generosity, speaking of dedicating to awakening, speaking of the distinctions of moral discipline, speaking of the power of patience, speaking of the tirelessness of diligence, speaking of the profound stillness of the meditative concentrations, speaking of thoroughly comprehending wisdom, speaking of thoroughly illuminating skillful means, speaking of loving-kindness as refuge, speaking of entering into compassion, speaking of the supreme rejoicing in joy, speaking of equanimity free from duality, speaking of being in accord with the truths, speaking of explaining the four individual perfect knowledges (pratisaṃvids), speaking of cultivating the six superknowledges (abhijñās), speaking the Dharma for those who rely upon one, speaking of thorough comprehension of the sūtra texts of Dharma, speaking of unforgetting mindfulness in the establishments of mindfulness, speaking of right diligence in the right abandonments, speaking of manifesting the bases of miraculous power, speaking of the sharpness of the faculties, speaking of the unimpairedness of the powers, speaking of the realization of the limbs of awakening, speaking of liberation through the path, speaking of entering into calm abiding, speaking of knowing the real through insight, speaking of thoroughly illuminating knowledge and liberation, speaking of the grounds of the śrāvaka vehicle precisely as they are, speaking of revealing the pratyekabuddha vehicle, speaking of proclaiming all the qualities of the Great Vehicle, speaking of conformity with the principles of dependent origination, speaking of having no fear of emptiness, speaking of signlessness, speaking of discerning wishlessness, speaking of showing the aggregates to be like illusions, speaking of the elements as being of the same nature as the element of space, speaking of the sense bases as empty of inherent existence, speaking of the seven noble riches (saptadhanāni), speaking of the six recollections, speaking with reverence, speaking of the six things to be properly rejoiced in, speaking of the six superknowledges, speaking of the six perfections, speaking of the five eyes, speaking of the ultimate truth, speaking of engaging in conventional truth, speaking of well-performed actions of karma, speaking of an even mind toward all sentient beings, and speaking of the immeasurable qualities and praises of all the dharmas of a buddha.

Furthermore, daughter, a bodhisattva's teaching of the Dharma is not speaking of a self, not speaking of a sentient being, not speaking of a life-force, not speaking of a person. It is not speaking of annihilation, not

speaking of permanence. It is not speaking of the view of arising, not speaking of the view of perishing. It is not speaking in acceptance of extremes, not speaking of attachment to the middle. It is not speaking of what is inconsistent, not speaking of contradiction, not speaking of dispute, not speaking of grasping at positions, not speaking of object-references. It is not speaking of being thoroughly enmeshed in views, nor of doubt, obscurations, severance, latent tendencies, or anger. It is not speaking in contradiction to the Dharma, not speaking of the destruction of the Dharma, not speaking of abandoning the Dharma, not speaking so as to engender conceit regarding the Dharma, and not speaking so as to engage with the Dharma in a mistaken way.

A bodhisattva who speaks the Dharma speaks of practicing the Dharma in accordance with the Dharma, speaks truthfully, speaks the Dharma, and speaks in a way that cannot be refuted by any opposing argument.

The bodhisattva's speaking of the Dharma, because it is connected with the appearance of all phenomena, is something difficult to turn back. The bodhisattva's speaking of the Dharma is a speaking of emptiness, whose domain of engagement is without object-reference. It is a speaking of signlessness, by virtue of being possessed of phenomena that are undisturbed. It is a speaking of wishlessness, by virtue of being unmixed with the three realms. It is a speaking of non-fabrication, by virtue of seeing the faults of the conditioned.

The bodhisattva's speaking of the Dharma is a speaking of birthlessness and non-arising, because the meaning of the Dharma is by its nature utterly secluded.

O daughter, what is called Dharma is: inexpressible, without letters, beyond designation, unspeakable, without form, incapable of being shown, without obstruction, not an object of discrimination, not something to be cognized by consciousness, free from mind, mentation, and consciousness, without dust, apart from dust, free from attachment, without darkness, without light, without self, without total grasping, not a grasper, free from grasping, without an object, not an object, unmixed with all objects, peaceful, released, difficult to behold, difficult to fathom, not a matter of reasoning, not to be comprehended by reasoning, known and realized only by noble ones who are wise, without feeling, with the stream of all feeling cut, empty in all three times just as they are, without death and transmigration, not something that

will transmigrate, without transmigration, without birth, neither flourishing nor declining, without arising, without disintegration, impossible to exist, not something that will arise, not something that will disintegrate, not something that is produced, not something that is destroyed, not to be understood, not to be understood in any encompassing way, not to be understood in any differentiated way, neither the appearance of characteristics nor the appearance of what lacks characteristics, of a single defining mark, without a defining mark, without a ground-basis, free from a ground-basis, without mixture, without attachment, without bondage, without liberation, without self, without total grasping, without engagement, without defilement, without similarity, without equivalence, neither unequal nor equal, neither false nor deceptive, without pleasure, without suffering, without gathering, without separation, without conjunction, without disjunction, without name, without form, without combination, without exclusion, without essence, yet not without essence, without division, yet not without division, not a vajra, not characterized by penetration, suchness itself that is not otherwise than suchness, neither far nor near, without color, without sign, without shape, without mark, not here, not elsewhere, not from that, not from another, not inner, not outer, not both, not other, not non-other, neither other-and-not-other, without seeing, without hearing, without mindfulness, without forgetfulness, without knowing, without consciousness, that from which consciousness is to be separated and with which consciousness has no part, without number, not without number, free from all enumeration — O daughter, this is what is called Dharma.

One who explains and perfectly teaches this with language and various symbols of this kind is called a bodhisattva who speaks the Dharma.

Furthermore, speaking the Dharma is a complete turning away from all other kinds of speech. Speaking the Dharma is not disputing with anyone. Speaking the Dharma involves no arrogance toward others. Speaking the Dharma does not hold in contempt those who have not trained.

Speaking the Dharma is not refusing to bow to those who have trained. It is not self-praise. It does not act contrary to the nature of reality. It teaches the Dharma with a stream of mind unmixed with material concerns. It does not give rise to regret in others. It does not speak of the transgressions of others. It does not belittle the Dharma. It does not obstruct the Dharma.

Speaking the Dharma sees no Dharma whatsoever as distinct on account of awakening. It does not teach the Dharma as something liberated from emptiness. It does not teach the Dharma as something liberated from signlessness and wishlessness. It does not divide the dharmadhātu. It does not stray from suchness. It does not utterly pass beyond the ultimate limit. It does not rely on the mere letter. It does not rely on consciousness. It does not rely on what is provisional. It does not rely on the person.

It is not contrary to meaning. It is not contrary to the letter. It is not contrary to primordial wisdom. It is not contrary to consciousness. It is not contrary to the definitive meaning. It is not contrary to the provisional meaning. It is not contrary to the nature of reality. It is not contrary to the person. It does not grasp at any partisan position. It does not act contrary to dependent origination.

Speaking the Dharma does not recognize purification through any worldly concern. It is not obscured by the affliction of miserliness. It is not in decline from moral discipline. It does not abandon sentient beings of bad character. It is without anger, malice, or resentment. It does not abide together with the stain of laziness.

Speaking the Dharma does not forget the awakening mind. It does not fritter away the hearing that is the root of wisdom. It does not disparage others. It does not bear aversion toward persons, nor aversion toward the Dharma. It does not set one sūtra against another. It does not treat the Vinaya as non-Vinaya. It does not act contrary to the nature of reality. In whatever Dharma rightly practiced, it sees nothing as non-Dharma. It does not further inflate pride with pride. It does not fall away from the Dharma. It does not fritter away what has been done. It does not cling to heedlessness. It does not cling with attachment to being honored. It is not angered by the absence of honor. It does not hold friends and enemies as two. It does not fritter away cause and effect.

Speaking the Dharma does not lack faith in the karmic maturation of actions. It does not withhold a response when spoken to. Speaking the Dharma is without enemies. It does not seek to deceive. It is without a double tongue. There is no pretense in body, speech, or mind. There is no pretense toward the Dharma.

Speaking the Dharma does not dwell in solitude merely to be seen as a teacher to others. It does not feign few desires merely in order to obtain things. It is not sinful through excessive great desire. Speaking the Dharma

does not present the awakening of the buddhas as something made by another. It does not undertake improper appropriation. It does not render the seven noble riches unfit. It does not eat flesh. It does not cut off the paternal lineage. It does not render the good qualities of others unfit. It does not speak of its own good qualities. It does not teach the Dharma of the buddhas as limited. I who speak the Dharma am never satisfied with proclaiming the praises of the Great Vehicle. For these reasons, this is called speaking the Dharma.

O daughter, in what way is a bodhisattva one who speaks of meaning? That which is not fabricated by intention — that is meaning. Perfectly accomplishing all wholesome roots through applied effort — that is meaning. The distinction of superior intention — that is meaning. Engaging others in genuinely taking up the awakening mind — that is meaning. Not expecting ripening from generosity — that is meaning. Causing sentient beings to experience happiness — that is meaning.

Not falling away from moral discipline — that is meaning. Not being wounded by patience — that is meaning. Bringing all purposes to completion through diligence — that is meaning. Coming to inner peace through meditative concentration — that is meaning. Being free of doubt through wisdom — that is meaning. Holding an even mind toward all sentient beings through loving-kindness — that is meaning. Acting on behalf of all sentient beings through compassion — that is meaning. Delighting in and being devoted to the Dharma through joy — that is meaning. Not discriminating among all pleasures and sufferings through equanimity — that is meaning. Having no regret from generosity — that is meaning. Having no anger through pleasing speech — that is meaning. Fulfilling the intention endowed with Dharma through purposeful action — that is meaning. Causing sentient beings to genuinely take up the Great Vehicle through harmonious intent — that is meaning. Bringing sentient beings to full maturation through the four means of gathering — that is meaning. That all formations are impermanent and suffering — that is meaning. That all phenomena are without self — that is meaning. That all afflictions are pacified — that is meaning. Relying on meaning rather than on the letter — that is meaning. Relying on wisdom rather than on consciousness — that is meaning. Among all sūtras, relying on sūtras of definitive meaning — that is meaning. From the words "life" and "person," relying on the nature of reality — that is meaning. Perfectly knowing each meaning and thus presenting an inexhaustible teaching — that is

meaning. Perfectly knowing each phenomenon and thus perceiving the dharmadhātu without confusion or intermixture — that is meaning. Perfectly knowing each expression of certainty and thus entering into the wisdom of the aggregates without remainder — that is meaning. Perfectly knowing each mode of confident eloquence and thus teaching the Dharma as occasion requires — that is meaning. Being insatiable with respect to the accumulation of generosity — that is meaning. Fulfilling aspirational prayers through the accumulation of moral discipline — that is meaning. Making diligent effort the very heart of the accumulation of learning — that is meaning. Fully accomplishing the major marks through the accumulation of merit — that is meaning. Knowing the superior and inferior faculties of all sentient beings through the accumulation of wisdom — that is meaning. Rendering the mind workable through the accumulation of calm abiding — that is meaning. Attaining knowledge and complete liberation through the accumulation of insight — that is meaning. Abiding in close mindfulness through the close applications of mindfulness — that is meaning. Generating all virtuous phenomena through the perfect abandonments — that is meaning. Traversing the ten directions through the bases of miraculous power — that is meaning. Perfectly discerning words through the spiritual faculties — that is meaning. Subduing all afflictions through the powers — that is meaning. Thoroughly comprehending all phenomena through the limbs of awakening — that is meaning. Not disturbing any phenomenon through the path — that is meaning. Never declining from the higher knowledges — that is meaning.

Thus, one who has genuinely tasted meaning from Dharma of just this character is one who speaks meaning in this way, and is not one who speaks non-meaning. In this way, a bodhisattva is one who speaks meaning.

O daughter, moreover: because all views that grasp at objects are to be completely pacified, the meaning of emptiness is meaning — and a bodhisattva who speaks of emptiness is one who speaks meaning. Because all conceptual thought and discursive thinking are to be abandoned, the meaning of signlessness is meaning — and a bodhisattva who speaks of signlessness is one who speaks meaning. Because one is to be freed from all aspirations belonging to the three realms, the meaning of wishlessness is meaning — and a bodhisattva who speaks of wishlessness is one who speaks meaning. In brief, likewise: because the continuum of all formations is to be cut, the meaning of non-formation is meaning. Because all birth is to be fully pacified, the meaning of birthlessness is meaning. Because none of the births that arise through

grasping are to be generated or produced, the meaning of non-arising and non-occurrence is meaning.

A bodhisattva who speaks of non-arising is one who speaks meaning. The meaning of suffering, of the origin of suffering, of the path, and of cessation is meaning — and one who speaks of cessation is one who speaks meaning. The meaning of the absence of a person in all phenomena is meaning — and one who speaks of the absence of a person is one who speaks meaning. The meaning of the inexpressibility of all sounds and words is meaning — and one who speaks of inexpressibility is one who speaks meaning. Because all vows and observances are to be perfectly fulfilled, the meaning of truth is meaning — and one who speaks truth is one who speaks meaning. The meaning of heedfulness with regard to all phenomena belonging to the side of awakening is meaning — and one who speaks of heedfulness is one who speaks meaning. The meaning of diligence with regard to all the objects of learning is meaning — and one who speaks of diligence is one who speaks meaning. The meaning that all vehicles are the Great Vehicle is meaning — and a bodhisattva who speaks of the Great Vehicle is one who speaks meaning.

Dear daughter, further still: the meaning of non-distinction is meaning. The meaning of the absence of sentient beings is meaning. The meaning of being of a single taste is meaning. The meaning of there being no difference is meaning. The meaning of being of a single mode is meaning. The meaning of being without words is meaning. The meaning of inexhaustibility is meaning. The meaning of impossibility is meaning. The meaning of non-arising and non-occurrence is meaning. The meaning of no coming and no going is meaning. The meaning of neither arising nor ceasing is meaning. The meaning of following along is meaning. The meaning of there being nothing to be raised up and nothing to be set down is meaning. The meaning of non-construction is meaning. The meaning of the unconditioned is meaning. The meaning of there being no superimposition is meaning. The meaning of non-cognizability is meaning. The meaning of thoroughly purifying the three spheres is meaning. The meaning of the equanimity of the three times is meaning. The meaning of the complete purity of the three spheres is meaning. The meaning of there being no wandering is meaning. The meaning of there being no destruction is meaning. The meaning of what is not shared in common is meaning. The meaning of there being no affliction whatsoever is meaning. The meaning of utter pacification is meaning. The meaning of there being no inquiry is meaning. The meaning of there being no coursing is meaning. The meaning of

there being nothing to grasp is meaning. The meaning of the prior limit and the later limit being wholly uncut is meaning. The meaning of non-agitation is meaning. The meaning of non-conceptualization with respect to what is Dharma and what is not Dharma is meaning. The meaning of entering the gnosis of the equanimity of extremes and no extremes, annihilation and permanence, is meaning. The meaning of diligently engaging with and thoroughly comprehending, just as they are, all letters, definitive words, sounds, and paths of expression is meaning. The meaning of not coursing in mind, mentation, consciousness, and conceptual elaboration is meaning. The meaning of non-conceptualization with respect to the afflictions of attachment, aversion, and delusion is meaning. The meaning of the equanimity of all phenomena — being undifferentiated and without multiplicity — is meaning. The meaning of emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness, and non-construction is meaning. The meaning of ultimate truth is meaning. The meaning of not depending on another is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is non-cognizability is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is thorough examination is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is suffering is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is seclusion is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is having no fixed abode is meaning. The meaning of not rendering purposeful activity unsuitable is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is non-distinction is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is suchness (tattva), suchness (tathatā), and not-otherwise-than-that suchness is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the definitive mark of being thoroughly tamed and certain is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the aggregates being of the essential nature of illusion is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the elements being of the nature of the dharmadhātu is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the sense bases being secluded is meaning.

The meaning whose characteristic is inner pacification is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is non-movement outward is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is generosity, discipline, and pacification is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is true reality that is without deception is meaning. The meaning that all afflictions are nothing whatsoever is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is being firm and indivisible like a vajra is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is non-contradiction with the entire world is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the perfection of all that is well done, carried to its ultimate end, is meaning. The

meaning whose characteristic is the thorough comprehension of following along with everything is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the absence of any obscuration to liberation is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is entering correctly into all destinies and proceeding in accordance with all the qualities of a buddha is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is correctly demonstrating what is equal and what is unequal is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is proceeding from meditative absorption and wisdom with certainty is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the definitive word, liberation, and the seeing of the wisdom of liberation is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is accordance with the causes of wisdom is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the thorough discernment of what has been examined is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is responding with correct understanding is meaning. The meaning whose characteristic is the perfect gathering of all meanings is meaning. Whatever meanings a bodhisattva who is endowed with such meaning as this has set forth — all of those are the teaching of meaning, and therefore one is called a speaker of meaning.

Now, young woman, in what way is a bodhisattva a speaker of Vinaya? The Tathāgata has taught Vinaya in two ways. What are the two? The taming of transgressions, and the taming of afflictions.

Regarding this, what is a transgression, and what is the taming of a transgression? What is called a transgression is that which arises from the root of conceptual fabrication, that which arises from the root of non-attention to what is appropriate, that which arises from the root of ignorance, that which arises from the root of distortion, that which arises from the root of what is not genuine, that which arises from the root of what does not exist, that which arises from the root of the transitory collection, that which arises from the root of clinging to a sentient being, that which arises from the root of remorse, that which arises from the root of what does not arise, that which arises from the root of doubt, that which arises from the root of clinging and bewilderment, and that which arises from the root of inferior wisdom. This is called a transgression.

Regarding this, what is the taming of a transgression? It is an arising that abides thoroughly in freedom from doubt. The transgression does not abide in any object, does not abide in any direction, has not become an aggregate, has nothing to be apprehended, and has no appearance. The mind too by which transgression has occurred is likewise: it is free from exhaustion, transformed,

not abiding in any object, not abiding in any direction, not become an aggregate, having nothing to be apprehended, having no appearance. Just as the mind is with regard to transgression, so it is likewise. Just as the transgression is, so too are all phenomena — they have no root and do not abide. That mind which is free from suspicion, free from turbidity, light, peaceful, free from all torment, clear, thoroughly pure, devoted to the word of the teacher, singularly certain without doubt, and singularly trusting — this is called the taming of a transgression.

Regarding this, what are afflictions, and what is the taming of afflictions? What are called afflictions are attachment, aversion, delusion, ignorance, craving, grasping, the twelve links of conditioned existence, and whatever engages with the conditioned. This is called affliction.

Regarding this, what is the taming of afflictions? It is this: all phenomena are utterly tamed. Why is that? Because all phenomena are tamed by emptiness.

In this regard, there is no wandering of attachment, there is no aversion, there is no delusion. All phenomena are tamed by being without characteristics. In this regard, there is no wandering of any affliction whatsoever. All phenomena are tamed by being without aspiration. In this regard, there is no wandering of any wandering whatsoever. All phenomena are tamed by being without volitional construction. In this regard, there is no wandering of any volitional constructing whatsoever. All phenomena stand at the edge of conditions. In this regard, there is no wandering of any fallen into views whatsoever.

With respect to all phenomena of dependent origination: certainty, and that which is exactly and truly so, and all afflictions being non-affliction, and utter peace, and emptiness — by that emptiness which is the emptiness of the emptiness of awakening, whereby all afflictions are empty — whoever has thus penetrated that emptiness: this is called the taming of afflictions. And whoever speaks thus is one who speaks of the Vinaya. Because one tames oneself, one is tamed; and whoever knows the taming of oneself knows the taming of afflictions.

Regarding this, what is the taming of oneself? It is knowing that there is no self in the self, knowing the essential nature of the self, knowing the self to be solitary and withdrawn, knowing the self as it truly is, knowing the self to be unagitated, knowing the self as emptiness, knowing the self as being without substantiality, knowing the self as suchness, knowing the self to be without referential support, knowing the self to be without agitation, knowing the self

to be without superimposition, and knowing the self to be forever without arising. Whoever knows the self in this way knows afflictions in all their aspects.

Just as perceiving a self in what has no self is an inverted perception, so likewise perceiving afflictions in what has no afflictions is an inverted perception. Just as the self is by intrinsic nature without a self, so too afflictions are by intrinsic nature without afflictions. Whoever knows this through insight is said to know the taming of afflictions.

In this regard, it is not past afflictions that are tamed, nor future ones, nor those arising in the present. Why is that? Because the absence of wandering and the absence of mental engagement — that is the taming of afflictions. That which is without wandering and without mental engagement is neither past, nor future, nor presently arising.

Just as the mind has no form, is not within, is not without, and is not apprehended in the absence of both, so likewise afflictions have no form, are not within, are not without, and are not apprehended in the absence of both. Because they are not apprehended, all afflictions are without harm, without pacification, without activity, without distinct activity, without an agent, without a distinct agent. Knowing afflictions in this way, as being without arising and without cessation — this too is the taming of afflictions.

When this teaching of truth, Dharma, meaning, and discipline was spoken, ten thousand bodhisattvas attained the patient acceptance of phenomena as non-arising. The maiden Ratnā was satisfied and pleased, joyful and rejoicing; gladness and mental ease arose in her, and she addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, how wondrous it is that the Tathāgata has so excellently taught this teaching of truth, Dharma, meaning, and discipline! Blessed One, those bodhisattvas who will speak thus will be devoted to non-contention, and they will teach the Dharma for the sake of abandoning the contention of all sentient beings."

"Maiden, a bodhisattva who has thus deeply tamed the afflictions, by teaching the Dharma in order to tame the afflictions of others as well — for that reason is called one who speaks of the Vinaya."

This concludes the chapter on the teaching of truth.

The second fascicle.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the maiden Ratnā: "Maiden, what is truth, and —"

Dharma, meaning, and discipline?" The maiden Ratnā replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, truth is inexpressible. Dharma is free from attachment. Meaning is beyond verbal formulation. Discipline is the seclusion of body and mind. That cannot be answered.

"Venerable Śāriputra, furthermore, truth is the truth of cessation. Dharma is the defining mark of truth. Meaning is free from syllables and words. Discipline is the defining mark of liberation. That too cannot be answered in words.

"Venerable Śāriputra, furthermore, truth is suchness (tathatā). Dharma is suchness that is none other than what it is. Meaning is the meaning of non-duality. Discipline is the meaning of non-action. That is without expression and cannot be demonstrated."

Then the venerable Śāriputra spoke to the maiden Ratnā as follows: "Maiden, what kind of jewel have you taken up, that you are called Ratnā — 'Jewel'?"

When he had said this, the maiden Ratnā replied to the venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, these thirty-two are the jewels — the manifest arousal of the awakening mind — of bodhisattvas, which no śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha possesses at all.

"What are these thirty-two? They are as follows: the precious arousal of the mind of omniscience for the sake of protecting all beings; the precious arousal of the mind that continues the lineage of the buddhas; the precious arousal of the mind that holds and preserves all Dharma lineages; the precious arousal of the mind that brings the Saṅgha's lineage to complete fulfilment without interruption; the precious arousal of the mind of great loving-kindness for the sake of establishing all sentient beings in the noble truths; the precious arousal of the mind of great compassion that removes all suffering for the sake of abandoning the afflictions of all sentient beings; the precious arousal of the mind of not looking to inner or outer things, giving up all possessions, for the sake of ripening to maturity those sentient beings who are miserly; the precious arousal of the mind of abiding oneself in moral discipline while ripening to maturity sentient beings of corrupt conduct; the precious arousal of the mind of patience — the strength of patience, contentment, ease, gentleness, peace, and restraint — whereby, even when one is chief among sentient beings who are malicious, faithless, wrathful, arrogant, conceited, or deceitful, and even when one possesses power over them, one does not

retaliate but instead cultivates patience, and the bodhisattva looks upon sentient beings with the strength of patience; the precious arousal of the mind of great diligence — without despondency, without weakness, without laziness, engaging in effort, not turning back from the Great Vehicle, not growing weary of the assembly, for the sake of ripening to maturity those sentient beings who are indolent; the precious arousal of the mind that does not turn back from meditative concentration even while remaining directed toward the desire realm and by means of skillful means — having mastered mindfulness, intelligence, realization, loving-kindness, the supreme meditative concentration, the various liberations, meditative absorption (samādhi), and the distinctions of meditative attainment, for the sake of ripening all sentient beings to maturity; the precious arousal of the mind transformed by wisdom — the discerning discrimination of wisdom, free from cataracts with respect to all phenomena, entering into the mode of non-duality exactly as it is, in a single manner, for the sake of engaging with all phenomena without obscuration;

the precious arousal of the mind that ripens all sentient beings into omniscience itself — possessing an intellect of equanimity toward all sentient beings, free from partiality, without distinction, and of a single flavor; the precious arousal of the mind free from attachment and free from anger, treating those who have shown respect and those who have not with perfect equality, dwelling well without pride and without servility, undisturbed in mind, unmoved by pleasure and by suffering, protecting all sentient beings; the precious arousal of the mind skilled in entering into profound dependent origination, free from fear, dread, and terror, seeing with and without limit, free from extreme views; the precious arousal of the mind that, insatiable in accumulating collections of merit, fully perfects the major marks and minor features of excellence; the precious arousal of the mind that longs to see the buddhas and is never parted from beholding them; the precious arousal of the mind that seeks earnestly to hear the Dharma, examines what has been heard, and thoroughly weighs the meaning; the precious arousal of the mind that teaches the Dharma exactly as it has been heard, without material concern; the precious arousal of the mind that has no concealment from one's teacher regarding the Dharma one has received; the precious arousal of the mind that always and continually holds in care those who have gone astray and taken up wrong conduct, who have fallen away from the Dharma and from moral discipline; the precious arousal of the mind free from contempt toward beginners who are untrained; the precious arousal of the mind free from pride,

manifest pride, and wrongful pride — without arrogance, amenable to instruction, harmonious in conduct, bowing down before all sentient beings; the precious arousal of the mind, great and majestic, with sharp faculties, free from the inferior and lesser vehicle, devoted to the Great Vehicle, aligned with the intention of the buddhas; the precious arousal of the mind free from the deeds of māra and from proximate afflictions — pure, stainless, and undefiled — yet delighting in conditioned existence suffused with the dust of attachment and afflictions, and never growing weary of it; the precious arousal of the mind that always, without interruption, dwells in solitude and sees the virtues of retreat — practicing solitude of body and mind — yet does not disparage mingling with the crowds of saṃsāra, out of great compassion; the precious arousal of the mind that abandons all happiness of gods and humans, all the happiness of meditative concentration, and all one's own happiness, and that, for the sake of ripening suffering sentient beings to maturity, never grows weary even through the experience of suffering; the precious arousal of the mind that, though possessed of the capacity, the fortune, the faculties, and the patience to attain the undefiled qualities — with liberation, as it were, come into the very palm of the hand — does not desire that liberation and does not abandon conditioned existence, but rather brings to full completion the qualities of a buddha; the precious arousal of the mind that, while discerning all phenomena individually as impermanent, as suffering, and as selfless, knows neither weariness nor attachment, but rejoices and rightly accomplishes the qualities conducive to awakening; the precious arousal of the mind that discerns all phenomena as empty, signless, wishless, and free from volitional striving, yet even while looking toward sentient beings does not actualize those very phenomena as direct experience, but keeps sight of sentient beings; and this precious arousal of the mind of the bodhisattva — possessed of the diligence of one whose very hair is aflame with fire, terrified on behalf of all migrating beings, never wearied of wandering in saṃsāra for innumerable eons for the sake of the primordial wisdom of omniscience.

The more and more one draws near to awakening, the more and more one relinquishes body, enjoyments, and

yet even as primordial wisdom becomes ever more vast and expansive, one abandons even that greatness itself and follows after the poor with compassion. This state of being without longing and without weariness — this too is the precious arousal of the awakening mind of the bodhisattva.

Those who fully ripen sentient beings do not, from the very outset, wish for their own personal awakening. This is the precious arousal of the mind endowed with the resolve of superior intention. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, these thirty-two constitute the precious arousal of the awakening mind of the bodhisattvas. Therefore they are called the source of the precious bodhisattva.

Then the Blessed One bestowed upon the maiden Ratnā his declaration of "Excellent!" and said: "Maiden, you have spoken well — excellent, excellent — in presenting this account of how one enters into the precious arousal of the awakening mind of the bodhisattvas. Maiden, those who arouse the mind toward unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening are noble persons, and the virtues to be taught are without limit. Why is that? From the precious śrāvakas and from the precious pratyekabuddhas, the precious Jewel of the Buddha does not arise; but from the precious Jewel of the Buddha, the precious śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do arise. From the precious awakening mind, the precious Jewels of the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha all arise."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how wondrous it is that the maiden Ratnā demonstrates such wisdom and eloquence, and that she has in this way severally and rightly understood each of these."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāradvatīputra, what do you think? Does it appear to you that the maiden Ratnā has not attained the four kinds of analytical knowledge? It should not be seen that way. The maiden Ratnā has attained analytical knowledge and an uninterrupted flow of eloquence."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said to the maiden Ratnā: "Maiden, since you have demonstrated analytical knowledge, speak with eloquence."

The maiden Ratnā replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, analytical knowledge performs in all respects the function of examining and teaching the Dharma. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, what is called the awakening mind — that very word is the expression that reveals analytical knowledge of meaning. Why? This arousal of the mind, which truly comprises all aims, is analytical knowledge of meaning. This arousal of the mind, which truly gathers all things within the dharmadhātu, is analytical knowledge of phenomena. All analysis and all definitive speech that arises from it — this is analytical knowledge of definitive expression. Teaching that arousal of the mind without obstruction, along with an uninterrupted flow of eloquence — this is analytical knowledge

of eloquence.

The meaning that neither moves nor abides is meaning; this is analytical knowledge of meaning. The nature of reality as apprehended by a magical mind is analytical knowledge of phenomena. Definitive expression through the gateway of discernment is analytical knowledge of definitive expression. A mind not attached to the six sense objects, with eloquence that is unimpeded — this is analytical knowledge of eloquence.

Meaning is definitive meaning. Phenomena is the seeing of solitude. Definitive expression is mere sound. Eloquence is the full discernment of sound. What is called 'buddha' is a term expressing profound realization. What issues from that is Dharma. That Dharma is elucidated by definitive expression. The teaching of eloquence is analytical knowledge of eloquence. The meaning of the Dharma is meaning. The nature of reality free from attachment is phenomena.

Analytical knowledge of phenomena is definitive expression. Eloquence with respect to phenomena is analytical knowledge of eloquence. The meaning of the Saṅgha and the meaning of the unconditioned are analytical knowledge of meaning. That which is of one taste with the Saṅgha and meaning is phenomena. Analytical knowledge of the Saṅgha is definitive expression. Whatever is thoroughly taught is analytical knowledge of eloquence. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, in this way, the teaching of the words of all phenomena should be understood as analytical knowledge.

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, for how long has the girl Ratnā been generating the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening? And whose scripture is the Tathāgata?"

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Śāradvatīputra, in times past, in the far distant past, beyond incalculable and vastly incalculable eons, there arose in the world a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha named Viśvadarśin — endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One. Śāradvatīputra, the buddha-field of that Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha Viśvadarśin came to be called 'The Supremely Pure World-Realm.' Śāradvatīputra, the enjoyments of the supremely pure world-realm were comparable to the enjoyments of the gods of Tuṣita. The bodhisattva Saṅgha

of that Blessed One consisted entirely of pure bodhisattvas — all seventy-six hundred million bodhisattvas were exclusively those who had achieved irreversibility, having emerged with certainty in dhāraṇī and eloquence.

"Śāradvatīputra, at that time and in that age, in the scriptural tradition of the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin, there appeared a wheel-turning king who was sovereign over a great trichiliocosm of world-realms, possessed of a treasury of jewels without limit, by name Puṇyavipākaviśuddha — 'He of the Completely Pure Karmic Maturation of Merit.' Śāradvatīputra, King Puṇyavipākaviśuddha had a retinue of queens numbering eighty-four thousand women, and all of them were exclusively ladies of excellent character. He had a thousand sons, and every one of them was endowed with the power of great strength.

"Śāradvatīputra, in this way, King Puṇyavipākaviśuddha, together with the bodhisattva Saṅgha, served the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin, for thirty-six hundred million years with pleasing robes, food, bedding, medicinal requisites for illness, furnishings, and every comfort. Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra again addressed the Blessed One with these words: 'Blessed One, what was the lifespan of that Tathāgata Viśvadarśin?' The Blessed One replied: 'Śāradvatīputra, the lifespan of the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin extended to ten intermediate eons.'

"Śāradvatīputra, if one were to make immeasurable offerings to that Tathāgata Viśvadarśin, to that King Puṇyavipākaviśuddha, together with his queens and his sons —"

with his retinue and attendants, preceded by ninety-two trillion living beings, went to where the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin was and arrived there. Having bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, he covered the seat with pearl garlands adorned with a hundred thousand ornaments, joined his palms together, and addressed the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin with these words: 'Blessed One, if I were to honor the Blessed One with every kind of offering, would there be any other offering, surpassing and superior, that I had not yet made to the Tathāgata?'

At those words, the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin, knowing the mind of King Puṇyavipākaviśuddha together with his retinue, spoke these verses:

Worlds as numerous as the grains of sand in hundreds of thousands of myriads of koṭis of Ganges rivers —

were one to fill them with precious things and give without interruption for a hundred koṭis of eons,

the merit from that still would not come close to even a hundredth part, nor could it bear comparison in any way,
to the merit of one who, for the sake of sentient beings, arouses compassionate loving-kindness and enters upon awakening.

Buddhas as numerous as the grains of sand in many thousands of myriads of koṭis of Ganges rivers —
were one to honor them with flowers and incense for many hundreds of thousands of myriads of koṭis of eons,
compared to one who, firm in awakening and bringing benefit, takes even seven steps forward —
that offering to the Victors is supreme, foremost, unsurpassed, and most excellent of all.

One who arouses the awakening mind with the aspiration to become a guide for the world —
such a one possesses generosity in the same measure, immeasurable moral discipline, and the supreme power of patience;
such a one has firm diligence, immeasurable meditative absorption, and unwavering wisdom.
Such a one treads the path of boundlessly accumulated merit, a merit that will never be exhausted.

One whose mind, by intention, rejoices greatly and enters earnestly into omniscience
will obtain renown, praise, fame, beautiful form, and the most excellent of attendants.
Such a one will ever attain mastery over enjoyments, powers, and possessions; mind and mindfulness will be noble.
Such a one will become a wheel-turning king endowed with power, and in that way will become Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) and Brahmā.

One in whom, face to face with dust-free, unsurpassed, and tranquil awakening, the awakening mind arises —
such a one severs all evil destinies, evil migrations, and all eight states of being without leisure.
Such a one fully opens and purifies all the pathways of gods and humans.
Such a one will not become blind, will not be deaf; all faculties will be complete.

One who enters upon awakening, endowed with intelligence, and seeks refuge for sentient beings,
who sees the buddhas, makes offerings to them, is skillful, and also listens to the Dharma —

such a one, possessed of wisdom and gnosis, will become one of exceedingly great and vast intelligence.

Such a one will be free from hesitation and wavering, free from pride, and will be upright at all times.

One who arouses the awakening mind and, endowed with such splendor, enters upon awakening —

such a one will find no delight in the pleasures of desire but will find delight in the Dharma.

Such a one will not be tainted by the stains of the world, like a lotus risen from the water.

Out of insatiable longing for wisdom, gnosis, and their qualities, such a one will seek out pure realms.

One who has entered upon awakening and, with compassion, is endless and cannot be exhausted —

such a one becomes a refuge, an island, a protector, and a father and mother to sentient beings.

Such a one becomes a physician for wandering beings, a master, a teacher, a great caravan leader.

Such a one bestows medicine for the world and beyond the world, and pacifies all illness.

Then Śāradvatīputra, that king of completely pure karmic maturation of merit, upon hearing from the Tathāgata Vipāśyin these qualities, benefits, and immeasurable merits of the awakening mind, felt satisfied, pleased, glad, and greatly joyful. Joy and mental ease arose in him, and from the very depths of his heart he generated the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. He then spoke these verses to that retinue of women, to his eldest son, to his ministers, to the kings of the frontier territories, and to that great assembly of people:

Having aroused compassion and loving-kindness toward sentient beings,
I have now entered upon the supreme, exalted awakening.

Whoever wishes for what is pleasing and delightful —
let them firmly and truly generate the awakening mind.

By means of the associations of birth, which have become suffering,
not having known cyclic existence before, with its countless ten millions of
aeons —

enter now upon the path of supreme awakening,
strive for the benefit of sentient beings, and suffering will turn to happiness.

Miraculous powers, confidence, and gnosis,
wisdom, retinue, and likewise offerings,
the vision of buddhas, and immeasurable qualities —
all these arise from the mind of omniscience.

Whatever happiness exists in the worlds of gods and humans,
Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the wheel-turning kings,
and whatever bliss there is, defiled and undefiled —
all these arise from the mind of omniscience.

The gathering of merit, meditative concentration, and the immeasurables,
likewise the path of the perfections,
higher knowledge, clear knowing, and individual perfect understanding —
all these arise from the mind of omniscience.

The ten powers of a buddha, forms beyond conception,
the fearlessnesses of the Tathāgata,
and the vast, immeasurable qualities of a buddha —
all of these without exception arise assuredly from the pure mind.

One who traverses tens of millions of realms,
causes all to understand through the sound of their voice,
and desires to spread the stainless throughout with light and adornment —
let such a wise one generate the awakening mind.

Whatever wise one generates the awakening mind
becomes worthy of veneration in all directions.

The Tathāgatas will sing their praises,
and without being asked, they will become a friend to wandering beings.

Even if all the buddhas, seeing with their vision,
were to speak praise across many aeons —
the merit arising from the awakening mind
could never be exhausted by any such telling.

The moment that King Completely Pure Karmic Maturation of Merit finished
speaking those verses, ninety-two billion sentient beings, along with the

retinue of the king's queens and those ten million sons, all generated the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. The great trichiliocosm, that vast world-system of three thousand times three thousand worlds, shook in six ways. Forty billion gods, raising their voices in sympathetic rejoicing, also generated the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

That wheel-turning king thereafter, for ten billion years, honored the Tathāgata Vipāśyin in every way that brought ease and comfort. He served as his attendant. He had his image made. He made offerings. He fully took up the five bases of training in the brahmacelibate life. Continuously, without interruption, accompanied by his retinue, he went to that Tathāgata for the sake of hearing the Dharma and listened to the Dharma.

At a later time, he installed his eldest son as king, shaved his hair and beard, put on the ochre robes, and with true faith went forth from home into homelessness. Having thus gone forth, he devoted himself to words of truth, words of Dharma, words of meaning,

words of discipline, and the four inexhaustible expressions — measuring them out by joining their syllables together. For ten million years he followed after one skilled in the brahmacelibate life. That king, having gone forth and trained under him, led beings beyond counting — far exceeding the number of sentient beings in the great trichiliocosm — to go forth into the scriptural teaching of that Tathāgata Vipāśyin. O son of Śāradvatī, if you should think that the king who was then called "One Whose Karmic Ripening of Merit Is Completely Pure" was someone else, do not view it so. This very girl Ratnakumārī was that king. And from that Tathāgata Vipāśyin, this girl Ratnakumārī aroused the mind of awakening.

Śāradvatī's son asked: Blessed One, by what kind of karmic obscuration has this girl taken hold of a woman's condition?

The Blessed One declared: O son of Śāradvatī, bodhisattvas do not take hold of the condition of womanhood through karmic obscuration. Why is that? O son of Śāradvatī, bodhisattvas take hold of the condition of womanhood through the power of higher knowledge, awareness, gnosis, skillful means, and wisdom, and all for the sake of bringing sentient beings to maturity. O son of Śāradvatī, what do you think of this? Even if one were to regard this girl Ratnakumārī as a woman, do not view her so. O son of Śāradvatī, she is to be regarded as a bodhisattva endowed with the power of higher knowledge; in her there are no phenomena of womanhood and no phenomena of manhood. This girl is

endowed with all virtuous qualities. She does not come. She does not go.

O son of Śāradvatī, this girl Ratnakumārī has brought ninety thousand young girls here in Jambudvīpa to full maturity for unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then the girl Ratnakumārī said this to the venerable son of Śāradvatī: Venerable son of Śāradvatī, does one not practice teaching the Dharma to sentient beings while in a woman's body?

Śāradvatī's son replied: Girl, I do not even desire this male body of mine — how much less need one speak of taking hold of a woman's body!

The girl said: Venerable son of Śāradvatī, do you then find fault with the body?

He said: Girl, I do find fault with it.

She said: Therefore, venerable son of Śāradvatī, a bodhisattva is supremely distinguished above all sentient beings. Why is that? Because whatever the śrāvakas find fault with, a bodhisattva does not find fault with. What is it that śrāvakas find fault with but bodhisattvas do not? Śrāvakas find fault with the aggregates, elements, and sense sources — bodhisattvas do not. Śrāvakas find fault with taking hold of a body — bodhisattvas do not. Śrāvakas find fault with taking hold of saṃsāra — bodhisattvas do not. Śrāvakas find fault with remaining in birth; but bodhisattvas do not find fault with taking hold of birth deliberately. Śrāvakas find fault with accumulating merit; but bodhisattvas do not grow weary of amassing the accumulation of merit. Śrāvakas find fault with associating with sentient beings; but bodhisattvas do not find fault with gathering company for the sake of bringing all sentient beings to maturity. Śrāvakas find fault with entering into villages and towns; but bodhisattvas do not find fault with entering into villages, towns, market settlements, provincial districts, and palace precincts. Śrāvakas find fault with their own mental afflictions; but bodhisattvas are not so with regard to the mental afflictions of all sentient beings —

O venerable Śāradvatīputra, thus it is that in whatever respects the śrāvakas find fault, in those very respects the bodhisattva does not find fault.

Śāradvatīputra then asked: "Young lady, what is the power of a bodhisattva by which one does not find fault in those ways?"

The young lady replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, these eight are the powers of a bodhisattva by which one does not find fault. What are the eight? The power of loving-kindness, by way of a mind free of anger; the power of

compassion, by way of bringing all sentient beings to maturity; the power of superior intention, by way of being free of artifice; the power of wisdom, by way of being free of mental afflictions; the power of skillful means, by way of never growing weary; the power of merit, by way of being without despondency; the power of gnosis, by way of being free of delusion; and the power of diligence, by way of bringing to fulfillment whatever one has previously committed to. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, these eight are the powers of a bodhisattva, and by these powers one does not find fault."

The elder then asked: "Young lady, do you yourself possess powers such as these?"

The young lady replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I possess them — I possess them by way of equanimity itself. I abide in equanimity by virtue of equanimity itself. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that equanimity is neither power nor weakness; it is simply equanimity. And in that equanimity there is not the slightest trace of distinction. What is called equanimity is space, and all phenomena are equal to space. Just as space has no appearance and no covering, so too all phenomena are, like space, without appearance and without covering. That which is thus equal is neither weak nor possessed of power. Nevertheless, venerable Śāradvatīputra, a bodhisattva who is humble in weakness is indeed possessed of power. Why? Whoever is humble in mental afflictions is possessed of the power of gnosis. Whoever is humble in miserliness is possessed of the power of generosity. Whoever is humble in bad conduct is possessed of the power of moral discipline. Whoever is humble in malice is possessed of the power of patience. Whoever is humble in laziness is possessed of the power of diligence. Whoever is humble in distraction is possessed of the power of meditative concentration. Whoever is humble in foolish wisdom is possessed of the power of wisdom. And so too with all phenomena: in whatever respect a bodhisattva is humble in non-virtue, in that very respect one is possessed of the corresponding power of virtue."

Then the Blessed One praised the young lady Ratnā, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, young lady! When teaching, one should teach precisely as you have taught." When this teaching was spoken, five hundred bodhisattvas gave rise to the acceptance of the Dharma.

Then the young lady Ratnā addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, through what root of virtue do those ten powers of the Tathāgata come about, such that one becomes endowed with the ten powers

of the Tathāgata?"

When she had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied to the young lady Ratnā with these words: "Young lady, that a bodhisattva, while engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, should desire the Lesser Vehicle and do what is not to be done — this is impossible; there is no such occasion. Through being endowed with this power of steadfast commitment, and having gone to the supreme and most excellent essence of awakening, one attains the power that is the knowledge of what is possible and what is not possible, knowing correctly and as they really are the possible as possible and the impossible as impossible. This is the first of the Tathāgata's powers. Having attained that power, the Tathāgata roars the lion's roar rightly in the midst of the assembly, proclaims the resolve of the foremost of herds, and whether to ascetics, or brahmins, or gods, or —

māras, or Brahmā, or anyone else in the world — he turns the pure wheel of Dharma that has not been turned in conformity with the Dharma by anyone in the world.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he is one who is shaped by his own karma and who relies upon karmic maturation. Through being endowed with this power of karmic maturation, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the maturation of past, future, and present karma, and of karma that has been properly undertaken — knowing it with regard to its basis and its cause. This is the second of the Tathāgata's powers. Having attained that power, the Tathāgata roars the lion's roar rightly in the midst of the assembly, proclaims the resolve of the foremost of herds, and whether to ascetics, or brahmins, or gods, or māras, or Brahmā, or anyone else in the world — he turns the pure wheel of Dharma that has not been turned in conformity with the Dharma by anyone in the world.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he examines the faculties of sentient beings and teaches the Dharma accordingly. Having understood them, he enters into those faculties exactly as they are and is endowed with those faculties exactly as they are. Through being endowed with this power of knowing the gradation of faculties, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the faculties and the gradation of diligence of other sentient beings and other persons. Dear girl, this perfect knowledge, exactly as it is, of the

faculties and gradation of diligence of other sentient beings and other persons — this is the third of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he enters into the constitutive elements of sentient beings, and having entered, he abides in accordance with their aspirations and their constitutive elements exactly as they are. Through being endowed with this power of entering into constitutive elements, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the many constitutive elements and the manifold constitutive elements of the world. This is the fourth of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he seeks out the aspirations of sentient beings who have different aspirations, and the wisdom of liberation as well, and in doing so he does not disparage those aspirations. Through being endowed with this power of aspiration, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the many and manifold aspirations of other sentient beings and other persons. This is the fifth of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he directs wisdom toward all conditioned and unconditioned things, toward the vehicle of the hearers, the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, and the Great Vehicle. Through being endowed with this power of knowing the all-pervading path, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the all-pervading paths. This is the sixth of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he applies himself assiduously to meditative concentration and meditative absorption, definitively examining the mind, free from afflictions, tamed and thoroughly knowing. Through being endowed with this power of thorough knowing, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, all the meditative concentrations, liberations, meditative absorptions, and states of meditative attainment of other sentient beings and other persons — together with their defilement and their purification. This is the seventh of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva,

he does not waste the roots of virtue arising from previous causes, and he is heedful, not declining from what was previously vowed. Through being endowed with this power of not wasting the roots of virtue arising from previous causes, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the power of recollecting the manifold previous abodes of himself, of other sentient beings, and of other persons. This is the eighth of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he does not disparage any sentient being, does not exercise authority over those who are untrained, and makes himself manifest to all sentient beings. Through being endowed with this power of making manifest, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the knowledge of the divine eye. This is the ninth of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he does not remain in a manner that would increase the defilements of any sentient being, but rather teaches the Dharma to sentient beings in order to exhaust their defilements. He does not teach for the sake of increasing defilements, but shows the path to sentient beings by way of the undefiled path. Through being endowed with this power of aspiring to the undefiled, and having attained awakening, he perfectly knows, correctly and as they really are, the knowledge of the exhaustion of all defilements. This is the tenth of the Tathāgata's powers.

Dear girl, these are the ten powers of the Tathāgata. When a bodhisattva has perfected all of these, he becomes a Tathāgata endowed with the ten powers. Dear girl, therefore, having heard this detailed analysis of the ten powers of the Tathāgata, a bodhisattva should, by all means, engage in the roots of virtue in order to fully perfect these ten powers of the Tathāgata.

Then the girl Ratnā addressed the Blessed One again, saying: Blessed One, what must one have in order for a bodhisattva to fully attain the four fearlessnesses and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha?

The Blessed One declared: Dear girl, in this regard, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, thinking "others should not know," he conceals nothing from a teacher, nor any Dharma teaching. He has an equanimous mind toward all sentient beings, fully relinquishes all possessions, sees all phenomena as equal, and is free from the perception of distinction.

When such a one attains awakening, he roars the lion's roar rightly and declares: "I am perfectly and completely awakened." Regarding such a declaration, he does not see any sign whatsoever that would make it right for some śramaṇa, brahmin, god, māra, Brahmā, or anyone else in the world to refute this with a reasoned objection in accordance with the Dharma. Since he does not see such a sign, the Tathāgata attains ease, attains freedom from fear, and attains fearlessness. He roars the lion's roar rightly in the midst of the assembly, takes the position of the supreme bull of the herd, and turns the pure wheel of Dharma — which no śramaṇa, brahmin, god, māra, Brahmā, or anyone else in the world could turn in accordance with the Dharma — and this, dear girl, is the first fearlessness of the Tathāgata.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he thoroughly knows, correctly and as they really are, the obstructive factors for what constitutes an obstruction, and he does not teach, does not engage with, does not practice those obstructive factors, and does not explain or teach them to others either.

knowing them to be obstructive factors, he abandons them. When that bodhisattva attains awakening, he roars the lion's roar: there is no conceivable case in which one who relies upon those factors that I have declared to be obstructive would not be obstructed. And as for "there is no one here who could challenge me" — that is as before. This is the second fearlessness.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he is continuously, without interruption, devoted to wholesome qualities. He enters the path of thorough purification and teaches the Dharma of complete purity to all sentient beings, making the nature of excellence directly manifest. Whatever collections of factors serve to purify one through the path of complete purity — those collections of factors he himself practices and also teaches to other sentient beings. When that bodhisattva attains awakening, he roars the lion's roar: there is no conceivable case in which one who relies upon those very factors I have declared to be the Dharma of thorough purification would fail to be purified. And "there is no one here who could challenge me" — that is as before. This is the third fearlessness.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he never at any time falls into the conceit of thinking "I know and see, while others do not know and do not see." He is continuously, without interruption, free from such conceit, and his mind is trained in distinguishing

and relinquishing evil. Possessed of this gift of Dharma, when he attains awakening he roars the lion's roar: there is no conceivable case in which, when he has proclaimed that his defilements are exhausted, it could rightly be said that some such defilement has not been fully exhausted. And "there is no one here who could challenge me" — that is as before. This is the fourth fearlessness.

Dear girl, furthermore, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, he continuously and without interruption seeks out the path for sentient beings who have lost their way, and levels out what is uneven along the path, making the high and the low, the unequal, equal. He also builds bridges and stepping-stones. In the darkness of the night he makes offerings of lamps at the stūpas of the Tathāgatas. For sentient beings dwelling in the remorse of transgression, he dispels their remorse over transgressions. He brings them out of their downcast state completely. He does not generate remorse in others. He does not speak of the transgressions of others when they occur. For sentient beings in whom doubt about the Dharma has arisen, he teaches the Dharma so as to cut through every doubt. He frees them from uncertainty, wavering, and hesitation. He accomplishes the illumination of Dharma. He properly generates the great light of wisdom. He entreats all buddhas, bodhisattvas, and Dharma-teachers to teach the Dharma. He grasps the Dharma correctly and, free from deceit, says "Excellent!" He does not denigrate any sentient being. He does not bind or ensnare. He does not cause others to become inflamed, hostile, infatuated, or confused regarding the Dharma. He does not put stock in the authoritative utterances of ordinary people. He regards all words as the speech of the buddhas. He does not look upon anything expressed in words through the accumulation of syllables or through the emptiness of syllables as faulty. He does not seek out occasions for quarrel. Possessed of this correct reception of Dharma, when he attains awakening he is called "free from dispute." He is one who, to all who inquire, teaches prophecy. There is no such thing for him as the absence of omnipresent manifestation, and through the meditative absorption of universal manifestation, which he cultivates at all times, skilled in the dhāraṇī that enters into all sounds and languages, he continuously and without interruption teaches the Dharma with the unerring words of the Tathāgata, giving prophetic teachings to all who inquire. This, dear girl, is the first unshared quality (dharma) of the Buddha among the Tathāgata's unshared qualities.

Moreover, dear girl, when a bodhisattva engages in the bodhisattva's conduct, he has abandoned every fault of speech. He speaks truthfully, speaks the Dharma, speaks what is meaningful, speaks the Vinaya, and does not speak frivolously, does not speak contentiously. Having abandoned all talk unworthy of a noble one, he attains the noble silence, and enters into the undisputed work of the ascetic's Dharma-activity. All those teachings he listens to, seeks out thoroughly, and teaches to others — he seeks out entirely with the intention of bringing peace and complete peace to himself and to others. Because he takes on nothing through contentiousness, he does not quarrel or dispute with anyone. He does not seek out enemies. He is devoted to the Dharma of having no enemies. He enters into the phenomena that are inexpressible. He has full faith in the spontaneously accomplished primordial wisdom of the Tathāgata. He leads other sentient beings as well to properly embrace this very nature of reality. Through being endowed with this properly received Dharma, when he attains awakening he is called "free from dispute," and that quality is absent in him: he does not utter or speak even a single syllable, and yet through all sounds and languages and through definitive words of teaching, with spontaneous accomplishment he speaks well and satisfies the retinue. Through deeply cultivating the meditative absorption of the King of Magical Emanations, and through being skilled in the dhāraṇī that accomplishes the gateway of boundless approaches, inconceivable tones and melodies of the Buddhas' Dharma arise from all the abodes, all the major marks, all the excellent minor marks, and all the pores of the Tathāgata — and even from a single sound there arises the teaching of immeasurable gateways of Dharma that satisfies the minds of the entire retinue. Through the blessing of former aspirations and through the power of primordial wisdom, the Tathāgata thereby abides in non-conceptuality and equanimity, spontaneously accomplished. This, dear girl, is the second unshared quality of the Buddha among the Tathāgata's unshared qualities.

Moreover, dear girl, when a bodhisattva engages in the bodhisattva's conduct, he is inseparable from the six recollections: recollection of the Buddha, recollection of the Dharma, recollection of the Saṅgha, recollection of ethical conduct, recollection of generosity, and recollection of the gods. He leads other sentient beings as well to properly embrace these recollections. Through being endowed with this properly received Dharma, when he attains awakening, the Tathāgata is said to be "without forgetfulness," and that quality is absent in him — meaning there is no forgetfulness in him at all.

Through deeply cultivating the meditative absorption of sovereignty over all phenomena, and through being skilled in the dhāraṇī of the lamp of the Dharma, he continuously and without interruption possesses the quality of being without forgetfulness toward the Tathāgata. Should all sentient beings, having reflected for an entire eon, ask the Tathāgata diverse questions without cessation, one after another, he does not think "I have explained this, I have taught that," nor does he deliberate; and yet, ever unconfused and with the faculty of mindfulness perfectly alert, he speaks well in a single instant, a single moment, a mere flash, and satisfies all sentient beings. This, dear girl, is the third unshared quality of the Buddha among the Tathāgata's unshared qualities.

Moreover, dear girl, when a bodhisattva engages in the bodhisattva's conduct, he continuously and without interruption guards the minds of others: he does not disturb others' minds, he does not cause minds to ache, he does not fixate on minds, he does not cut off their roots of virtue, he does not fixate on phenomena. Regarding all phenomena, he understands them to be like illusions. He is without agitation and without conceit, and holds equanimity of mind toward all sentient beings. He sees all phenomena as of one taste in equality, enters into the dharmadhātu free from mixture and of a single taste, and abides therein.

Being endowed with this properly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening there is not a single arising of mind that is not held in meditative equipoise. Through having thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption of the intrinsically equal nature of all phenomena, free from conceptual elaboration, and through mastery of the dhāraṇī of the gateway of total encompassment, one enters into the activity of the Tathāgata's buddhahood in a state of meditative equipoise and in the manner of spontaneous accomplishment. This, dear daughter, is the fourth unmingled quality of the Tathāgata's buddhahood.

Furthermore, dear daughter, when a bodhisattva engages in the bodhisattva's conduct, he is without inverted perception. He is without inverted mind, without inverted view, and without the inversion of superimposing existence upon what does not exist. He does not perceive a self, does not perceive a sentient being, does not perceive a life force, does not perceive a nurtured one, does not perceive a person, does not perceive one born from seed, does not perceive offspring, does not perceive annihilation, does not perceive permanence, does not perceive arising, does not perceive destruction. He

does not perceive duality with regard to virtue and non-virtue, the blameworthy and the blameless, the defiled and the undefiled, the worldly and the supramundane, affliction and purification, saṃsāra and nirvāṇa. And though he teaches sentient beings who are attached and clinging to perceptions how to abandon inverted perceptions, he himself is free from any perception of greatness or distinction. He has entirely abandoned all extreme views and has entered the Middle Way. He sees the equal nature of all phenomena.

Being endowed with this properly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening, this is called the Tathāgata's having no perception of distinction from others — and in him that is entirely absent. Through having thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption free from signs, and through mastery of the dhāraṇī of the inexhaustible treasure-basket, the Tathāgata abides in the signless abode and yet does not turn back great compassion toward sentient beings who grasp through perception at all signs and who move about in conceptual thought. He is perfectly attuned to the proper time for taming sentient beings, and does not interrupt the stream of teaching the Dharma. This, dear daughter, is the fifth unmingled quality of the Tathāgata's buddhahood.

The third fascicle.

Furthermore, dear daughter, when a bodhisattva engages in the bodhisattva's conduct, he is continually and without interruption equanimous. Toward all phenomena of affliction and suffering that operate within saṃsāra, he is equanimous, and he has no attachment to the phenomena of any state of physical happiness or mental ease. Toward all phenomena of any state of physical suffering or mental discomfort, he has no anger. Free from attachment and anger in this way, when he obtains and acquires all things he does not become puffed up with pride, and when he loses and is stripped of all things he does not become dispirited. He is equanimous through examining all formations individually as impermanent and as suffering, having conviction in selflessness and in nirvāṇa as peace. He also leads other sentient beings to properly take hold of this very nature of equanimity for themselves.

Being endowed with this properly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening, this is called the Tathāgata's having no equanimity that is uninvestigated and unreflective — and in him that equanimity is entirely absent. Through having thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption of

liberation from attachment to duality, and through mastery of the dhāraṇī of the ocean-seal mudrā (skt. samudramudrā), the Tathāgata — toward gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (skt. gandharva), asuras, garuḍas (skt. garuḍa), kinnaras (skt. kinnara), great serpents (skt. mahoraga), Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, and

the world-protectors, and all humans and non-humans — even while being praised, honored, worshipped, and depicted in images, feels no attachment in return. And when disturbed and harmed by māras, by other tīrthikas (non-Buddhist adherents), by adversarial opponents, and by all hostile sentient beings, the Tathāgata feels no anger; his mind remains even and equanimous toward those who benefit him and those who harm him alike. He does not become filled with a mind like earth, a mind like water, a mind like fire, or a mind like wind. He is not scorched, not agitated. With a mind like space, he abides in equanimity, dwelling in equanimity toward all sentient beings. Endowed with this equanimity of the Dharma-resolving mind, his great compassion toward all sentient beings never turns back; he is skilled in the right time for taming sentient beings, and never breaks the stream of teaching Dharma as appropriate. This, young woman, is the sixth of the Tathāgata's unshared qualities of the Buddha.

Young woman, furthermore, when a bodhisattva practices the conduct of a bodhisattva, he maintains a strong and unceasing aspiration at all times. Through vast aspiration, great aspiration, and deep aspiration, he aspires to the thorough seeking of all wholesome roots and to the production of manifold wholesome roots. He aspires to abandon entirely what is of the śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas. He aspires to be irreversible from the Great Vehicle. He aspires never to abandon the mental engagement of extending great compassion to all sentient beings. He aspires to accomplish the Dharma of buddhas through his own investigation and realization, without relying on others. Not a single māra, nor any other tīrthika holding views with fixed objects of reference, nor any sentient being who has that aspiration, is able to separate him from that aspiration. Endowed with this properly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening, this is called the Tathāgata's having no deterioration of aspiration — and in him that is entirely absent. Through having thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption of aspiration and the meditative absorption of formations, and through mastery in the dhāraṇī of the vajra-banner, he teaches whatever among all phenomena is to be taught. In whatever instant, moment, or brief interval of time — whatever hour,

whatever other land, whatever stream of mind among sentient beings — he teaches Dharma as is fitting and in accordance with the vessel, and yet he never abandons the state of meditative equipoise. This, young woman, is the seventh of the Tathāgata's unshared qualities of the Buddha.

Young woman, furthermore, when a bodhisattva practices the conduct of a bodhisattva, he applies diligence without cease at all times. He never abandons constant striving. He knows no satiety in properly accomplishing and engaging in wholesome roots. He inclines toward undertaking what is blessed, and goes before all teachers, spiritual friends, Dharma speakers, buddhas, and bodhisattvas. He thoroughly inquires of them, attends them with respect, renders them service and offering — all in order to: thoroughly embrace saṃsāra for measureless eons; thoroughly ripen measureless sentient beings; thoroughly purify measureless buddha-fields; make offering and render service to measureless buddhas; thoroughly uphold the measureless Dharmas of the buddhas; bring about full and perfect awakening to measureless Dharmas of the buddhas; enter into the measureless conduct of sentient beings; and become skilled in teaching the measureless Dharmas of the buddhas. For these purposes, his diligence is made boundless. Endowed with this properly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening, this is called the Tathāgata's having no deterioration of diligence —

— and in that regard, that deterioration is entirely absent.

Through profound cultivation of the meditative absorption of diligence and the meditative absorption of formations, the Tathāgata displays measureless miraculous displays of supernatural power (ṛddhi) — supreme among the herd — in order to take hold of and discipline measureless sentient beings; yet toward those miraculous powers he has no attachment, no obscuration, no obstruction. He travels to all buddha-fields, and while he moves toward and pervades them all, he does so without any compulsive formations, roaming freely through everything like open space. This, O daughter, is the Tathāgata's eighth unshared quality of a buddha — the absence of deterioration of supernatural power — and in that regard, that deterioration is entirely absent.

Moreover, O daughter, when a bodhisattva is engaging in bodhisattva conduct, his mindfulness is always complete and uninterrupted without break, and he is endowed with supreme mindfulness and vigilance. That mindfulness of his is without forgetfulness. He is not one who strives in the yoga of cultivating the close application of mindfulness to all worldly and supramundane phenomena.

Rather, he dwells observing the inner body in the aspect of the body, applying and engaging attention in the modes of impermanence, suffering, selflessness, and unattractiveness. He dwells observing the outer body and the inner-outer body in the aspect of the body, applying and engaging attention in the modes of impermanence, suffering, selflessness, and unattractiveness. He dwells observing the inner feelings in the aspect of feelings, applying and engaging attention in the mode of emptiness. Likewise, he dwells observing the outer feelings and the inner-outer feelings in the aspect of feelings, applying and engaging attention in the mode of emptiness. He dwells observing the inner mind in the aspect of the mind, applying and engaging attention in the mode of signlessness. He dwells observing the outer mind and the inner-outer mind in the aspect of the mind, applying and engaging attention in the mode of signlessness. He dwells observing the inner phenomena in the aspect of phenomena, applying and engaging attention in the mode of wishlessness. He dwells observing the outer phenomena and the inner-outer phenomena in the aspect of phenomena, applying and engaging attention in the mode of wishlessness.

He cultivates the close application of mindfulness that has entered into the body, applying and engaging attention in the modes of impermanence, suffering, selflessness, and unattractiveness — yet he also never cuts the continuum of rightly engaging in physical deeds, for the sake of completely accomplishing the Tathāgata's form body.

He cultivates the close application of mindfulness that has entered into feelings, applying and engaging attention in the mode of emptiness — yet, beholding with compassion the sentient beings born in all the lower realms and perceiving that all their painful feelings must be severed, he never cuts the continuum of great compassion toward those sentient beings.

He cultivates the close application of mindfulness that has entered into mind, applying and engaging attention in the mode of signlessness — yet he does not forget the awakening mind, and never cuts the continuum of properly accomplishing the assembly of the Great Vehicle.

He cultivates the close application of mindfulness that has entered into phenomena, applying and engaging attention in the mode of wishlessness — yet he does not actualize the nature of reality that is free from attachment as a direct perception, and he remains in harmony with the qualities of a buddha, entering perfectly into the dharmadhātu, which is without boundary or center.

Endowed with this properly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening, this is called the Tathāgata's having no deterioration of mindfulness — and in that regard, that deterioration is entirely absent.

Through the profound cultivation of meditative absorption endowed with the formations of abandonment, the Tathāgata's miraculous display — wherein all things are fully revealed — encompasses the following: the past extreme and the future extreme and the present moment of the minds of all sentient beings, passing from one to the next; the passing from one to the next of their faculties, their elements, and their aspirations; the habitual tendencies of afflictive conduct, their intentions, their underlying latencies, their entanglements, and the karmic maturation of their virtuous and non-virtuous actions, passing from one to the next; their lives, their deaths and transmigrations, and their rebirths, passing from one to the next; their eons and the buddhas appearing in their fields, passing from one to the next; the assemblies of śrāvakas and the predicted bodhisattva conduct, passing from one to the next; and their fathers, mothers, relatives, and the bonds of close kinship, passing from one to the next. With respect to the revelation of all of these, the faculty of mindfulness is unobstructed and without confusion. This prophecy, encompassing everything, is the ninth unshared quality of the Tathāgata, the quality of a buddha.

Furthermore, daughter, when a bodhisattva engages in bodhisattva conduct, it is always, uninterruptedly, a conduct of wisdom. The bodhisattva possesses the light of wisdom, the illumination of wisdom, the investigation of wisdom, the faculty of wisdom, sharp wisdom, profound wisdom, discerning wisdom, indomitable wisdom, wisdom that cannot be overwhelmed, wisdom whose depths are hard to fathom by all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, wisdom that is vast and expansive yet with a mind of equanimity, transcendent wisdom, wisdom that applies appropriate attention without relying on oral transmission, and wisdom that has never known satisfaction in seeking learning. Having heard the Dharma, one comprehends and realizes it through wisdom, tending to it as if one's head were ablaze with fire, and one seeks learning and makes learning one's very essence, accumulating learning. One desires the Dharma and is devoted to the delight of Dharma's joy. One strives diligently to seek out the sacred Dharma entirely. This one who so desires the Dharma surrenders without reservation whatever inner or outer possessions one has. There is nothing one will not do in service to one's teacher. There is no burden of suffering one cannot endure. There is nothing in the way of comfortable

provisions that one does not wish for.

This one who desires the Dharma takes supreme delight in hearing even a single verse of four lines — not in receiving a great trichiliocosm world-system filled entirely with precious jewels. One takes supreme delight in a single word of the Dharma — not in attaining the sovereignty of a wheel-turning king (cakravartin). One takes supreme delight in hearing of the path of the perfections — not in attaining the positions of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) or Brahmā. One takes supreme delight in teaching even a single verse of four lines to others — not in performing offerings as many and as boundless as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā. One takes supreme delight in leading others to take up the awakening mind correctly — not in attaining sovereignty as wheel-turning kings as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā. One takes delight in teaching others the perfections and the Dharma discourse full of excellence — not in attaining the positions of Śakra and Brahmā as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā.

One who has entered into such an elevated intention receives the Dharma with reverence and hears it. One receives it with reverence and teaches it to others. Through such earnest endeavor, with little difficulty, one is completely embraced by all the gods and kept in mind by all the buddhas.

Being completely embraced by all the gods and held in mind by all the buddhas, every form of knowledge, both worldly and transcendent, becomes directly manifest within oneself. This is not a light that is extinguished, for it is the light of wisdom that is inexhaustible. Possessing this gateway of the light of Dharma, when awakening is attained, this is called "the Tathāgata's wisdom is without decline," for in the Tathāgata there is no such decline.

The wisdom of a Tathāgata is unobstructed and unimpeded with regard to knowing the mental conduct of all sentient beings — their virtue and non-virtue; what is morally neutral; what is blameworthy and what is blameless; what is defiled and what is undefiled; what is worldly and what is transcendent; what is afflicted and what is purified; saṃsāra and nirvāṇa; knowing how to teach and elucidate the comprehension of all gateways of Dharma; and knowing how to teach kalpas as numerous as the finest atoms of all buddha-fields. That wisdom is unobstructed and unimpeded. That wisdom is free from attachment and unimpeded with regard to the past, the future, and the present, utterly without obstruction in all respects. Even if one were to teach all the Tathāgatas about what lies beyond the ultimate limit, it would be

inexhaustible.

Through profound cultivation of the meditative absorption of the conditioning factors of analysis, and by means of the miraculous display of instruction that follows from it, all gateways of Dharma appear from a single gateway of Dharma of the Tathāgatas, and that single gateway of Dharma perfectly establishes all gateways of Dharma. This, noble girl, is the tenth of the unshared buddha-qualities of the Tathāgata.

Moreover, noble girl, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, one continually and without interruption does not seek the affairs of household life. One does not seek the objects of desire. One delights in going forth from the household and frequently goes forth. One inclines toward seclusion, falls toward seclusion, rests in seclusion, and strives in the yoga of meditating upon the profound Dharma. One meditates upon these three gates of liberation: emptiness, the signless (Skt. *animitta*), and the wishless.

Through meditating upon these three gates of liberation — which are beyond the domain of all opponents' arguments and are not comprehended by them, and which are not comprehended by those who cling with delight to signs and regard them as objects — the liberation called "freedom from obscurations" arises completely. The luminosity of wisdom free from attachment is fully attained. One wholly transcends the domain of *māra*. The domain of wisdom is brought to complete perfection. One engages with none of the obscurations, interruptions, entanglements, views, afflictions, or signs. Having fully attained the liberation free from obscurations and excelling in the three gates of liberation, one teaches the profound Dharma.

One relies upon the meaning, not upon the letter. One relies upon wisdom (*jñāna*), not upon consciousness (*vijñāna*). One relies upon the definitive meaning, not upon the provisional meaning. One relies upon the nature of reality, not upon the person. One becomes a support for all sentient beings: those who are attached and clinging to words and conceptual thought are liberated by teaching them to rely upon the meaning. Those who are attached and clinging to the signs of consciousness are liberated by teaching them to rely upon wisdom. Those who are attached and clinging through superimposition upon the provisional are liberated by teaching them to rely upon the definitive meaning. Those who are attached and clinging to persons are liberated by teaching them to rely upon the nature of reality. Those who are attached and clinging to the sixty-two erroneous views are liberated by

teaching them emptiness.

Those who are attached and clinging to all the obscurations of conceptual thought are liberated by teaching them the signless. Those who are attached and clinging to the three realms are liberated by teaching them the wishless. Those who are attached and clinging through the attachment of desire are liberated by teaching them the aspect of the unattractive. Those who are attached and clinging to the practice of aversion are liberated by teaching them loving-kindness. Those who are attached and clinging to the practice of delusion are liberated by teaching them dependent origination. Those who are attached and clinging to miserliness are liberated by teaching them the perfection of generosity. Those who are attached and clinging to conduct that is base are liberated by teaching them the perfection of moral discipline. Those who are attached and clinging to harmful intent are liberated by teaching them the perfection of patience. Those who are attached and clinging to laziness are liberated by teaching them the perfection of diligence. Those who are attached and clinging to distraction are liberated by teaching them the perfection of meditative concentration. Those who are attached and clinging to mistaken wisdom are liberated by teaching them the Perfection of Wisdom. Those who are attached and clinging to the ways of ordinary beings are liberated by teaching them the noble truths. Those who are attached and clinging to inverted views are liberated by teaching them impermanence, suffering, selflessness, and peace. Those who are attached and clinging to all forms of obscuration, obstruction, entanglement, and wrong views are liberated by teaching them the unobscured liberation. Those who are attached and clinging to all that is afflicted are liberated by teaching them the phenomena conducive to awakening.

One who has properly taken up this Dharma and who, upon attaining awakening while endowed with it, undergoes no deterioration in liberation with respect to the Tathāgata — in that one, there is none of that deterioration. That liberation is undisturbed and utterly consummate; it has become a thing of perfect coolness, free of waves, and it is profound — unfathomable in its depths by all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and it follows in the wake of the equality of all buddhas. It is stainless, free from stain, unmuddied, and utterly pure. By thoroughly training in the grounds of calm abiding and insight, it is inexhaustible. Its teaching is boundless and without limit. It is without attachment and without obscuration. It gathers fully in the expanse of space. Through the thorough cultivation of the meditative absorption of the stainless

essence, and through being skilled in dhāraṇī with the luminous appearance of all phenomena, it is in accord with the teaching of the Dharma of the defining characteristics of liberation set forth by all the Tathāgatas. Arising from everything and endowed with the luminous appearance of all phenomena, it inclines toward nirvāṇa, flows into nirvāṇa, and arrives at nirvāṇa. This, which is utterly consummate and utterly perfected, is, O daughter, the eleventh of the unshared buddha-qualities of the Tathāgata.

Furthermore, O daughter, when a bodhisattva practices the conduct of a bodhisattva, that one takes wisdom as paramount — endowed with the power of wisdom, flowing into wisdom, and possessed of the splendor of wisdom. That wisdom is unfailing; it arises definitively from having thoroughly trained in the supernormal cognitions of beings. Endowed with the discerning intelligence of omniscient wisdom, and through that discerning intelligence of omniscient wisdom, one truly and precisely knows a mind accompanied by attachment as a mind accompanied by attachment.

One truly and precisely knows a mind free from attachment as a mind free from attachment. Likewise, one truly and precisely knows a mind accompanied by aversion and one free from aversion; a mind accompanied by delusion and one free from delusion; a mind accompanied by affliction and one free from affliction; a mind that is distracted and one that is not distracted; a mind accompanied by torpor and one free from torpor; a mind that grasps at supremacy and one that does not; a mind that is exalted and one that is not; a mind accompanied by obscurations and one free from obscurations; a mind that has received a prophecy and one that has not; a virtuous mind and a non-virtuous mind; a mind accompanied by blame and one free from blame; a mind accompanied by defilements and one free from defilements; a worldly mind and one that has transcended the world; a mind that is thoroughly afflicted and one that is not; a mind that is thoroughly pure and one that is not; a narrow and an expanded mind; a bounded mind and a boundless mind; a mind possessed of miserliness and a mind possessed of generosity; a mind of bad character and a mind devoted to moral discipline; a mind with the underlying tendency toward ill-will and one free from ill-will; a lazy mind and a mind possessed of diligence; a distracted mind and one in meditative equipoise; a mind of corrupt wisdom and a mind possessed of wisdom; the mind of an ordinary person; a mind determined toward wrong views; a mind determined toward the truly correct; a mind determined toward the vehicle of the śrāvakas; a mind determined toward the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas;

and a mind determined toward the Great Vehicle — all these one truly and precisely knows.

One truly and precisely knows: "This is the noble truth of suffering." One truly and precisely knows: "This is the origin of suffering, this is the cessation of suffering, this is the path leading to the cessation of suffering." Through the knowledge of non-arising, one truly and precisely knows the noble truth of suffering. Through the knowledge of the origin — of that which moves about so extensively — one truly and precisely knows the origin. Through the knowledge of cessation — that which is utterly momentary, without annihilation and without permanence — one truly and precisely knows cessation. Through the knowledge of thorough purity — following along with everything, gathering into space like open sky, without a self, without any grasping — one truly and precisely knows the path.

Although one thus truly and precisely knows these four noble truths, one does not yet actualize them directly, so as to bring sentient beings to full maturation. Instead, one teaches the Dharma to sentient beings for the sake of fully knowing the truths, abandoning them, cultivating them, and directly actualizing them. That teaching of the Dharma is in accord with truth; it is not in conflict with dependent origination; it has thoroughly abandoned all extreme views; it has entered the Middle Way; and it manifests the dependently arising phenomena. In that teaching, one truly and precisely knows: all phenomena arise from the side of causes and conditions — not from the side of a self, not from the side of a sentient being, not from the side of a life-force, not from the side of a nourishing principle, not from the side of a person, not from the side of an individual.

One truly and precisely knows formations conditioned by ignorance. Conditioned by formations arises consciousness; conditioned by consciousness arise name-and-form; conditioned by name-and-form arise the six sense bases; conditioned by the six sense bases arises contact; conditioned by contact arises feeling; conditioned by feeling arises craving; conditioned by craving arises clinging; conditioned by clinging arises becoming; conditioned by becoming arises birth; conditioned by birth arise aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering,

mental discomfort, and distress arise. In just this way, one truly and precisely knows that this vast, unmixed mass of suffering comes into being. And from the cessation of ignorance through to the cessation of aging and death, one

truly and precisely knows that this vast, unmixed mass of suffering ceases.

When one trains correctly in this, one understands that whatever arises in dependence on the condition of ignorance does not arise from the condition of a self, does not arise from the condition of a sentient being, does not arise from the condition of a life-force, a living being, or a person. That which does not arise from the condition of a self, through to that which does not arise from the condition of a person — all of that is empty. Whatever is empty is neither annihilation nor permanence. Whatever is neither annihilation nor permanence is primordially unborn and unarisen. Whatever is primordially unborn and unarisen is inexpressible across the three times. Whatever is inexpressible across the three times has the essential nature of non-thingness. Whatever has the essential nature of non-thingness is without number and utterly beyond enumeration. Whatever is without number and utterly beyond enumeration is the ultimate. Whatever is the ultimate is the authentic word of the buddhas. Whatever is the authentic word of the buddhas is free from conflict and dispute. Whatever is free from conflict and dispute is the Dharma of the contemplative. Whatever is the Dharma of the contemplative, knowing and abiding in this way with a nature equal to space — through the arising of what is not in accord with reality, ignorance arises, and this one truly and precisely knows. From the cessation of ignorance through to the cessation of aging and death one truly and precisely knows, and through the understanding that arises from the gathering of causes and conditions one is not led into the view of annihilation; rather, one follows the Dharma of no-self, no sentient being, no life-force, and no person. One does not assent to any extreme, does not grasp, does not apprehend. Because no extreme is apprehended, the middle is not truly seen either. For a phenomenon in which no extreme is apprehended, how could there be a middle? Thinking, "What would such an extreme even be like?" — one enters into phenomena that are free from extreme and middle. The dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, is free from extreme and middle, and so it teaches phenomena that are free from extreme and middle.

One who possesses this correctly undertaken Dharma and thereby attains awakening beholds in the Tathāgata a liberating wisdom that is called Unequaled — in that there is nothing in the Tathāgata that is not that. Through having cultivated in depth the meditative absorption of the Array of Powers, and through mastery of the dhāraṇī that coils without end, the liberating wisdom one thus beholds is perfectly gathered into the

dharmadhātu, which is free from extreme and middle. With regard to teachings that reveal what is the case and what is not the case, it is vast like the expanse of space — non-conceptual and spontaneously accomplished. With regard to teachings that illuminate the knowledge of past, future, and presently arisen karma that has been correctly undertaken, it teaches that karmic maturation is never wasted. With regard to teachings that illuminate knowledge of the faculties and the degrees of diligence of all sentient beings, it is manifest and direct. With regard to teachings that reveal worlds of many and various elements, it teaches with supreme and unfailing clarity. With regard to teachings that illuminate the many and various dispositions and inclinations, it teaches them inexhaustibly and enters into them. With regard to teachings that illuminate the path pervading all, it extensively distinguishes and prophesies the exhaustive differentiation of every directional network. With regard to meditative concentration, liberation, meditative absorption, meditative attainment, thorough affliction, and

With regard to teachings that reveal the knowledge of thorough purification, it sets forth the inconceivable gateways of Dharma in their full arrangement. With regard to teachings that reveal the knowledge of recollecting many former abodes, it teaches the wisdom that is unobstructed and unobscured regarding the death, transmigration, lifespan, and birth — superior, middling, and inferior — of all sentient beings, with no beginning or end. With regard to teachings that reveal the knowledge of the divine eye (clairvoyance of the celestial sight), unimpeded and unobscured, it teaches the scriptural prophesy of utterly complete purification in every aspect of universal vision. With regard to teachings that reveal the knowledge of the exhaustion of all defilements, it teaches the knowledge of abandoning without remainder every connection born of habitual tendencies. With regard to teachings that reveal the knowledge of fearlessness, it teaches that which cannot be overawed. With regard to teachings that reveal the knowledge of the power of great compassion, it teaches the uninterrupted, continuous, and equal engagement — without distinction in all the activities of a buddha — of an involvement that is uniform and unceasing. With regard to teachings that individually teach the Dharma according to what is fitting, it teaches manifestation through spontaneously accomplished wisdom. In order to fully ripen and discipline all sentient beings, with regard to teachings that reveal the domain of the wisdom that supremely turns the inexhaustible wheel of Dharma, it teaches the wisdom of depth, variety, interweaving, flowing gently, discernment, skillful

means, power, and manifestation. This is not shared with any śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha. This, dear girl, is the twelfth of the Tathāgata's unmingled buddha qualities.

Furthermore, dear girl, when a bodhisattva engages in bodhisattva conduct, the bodhisattva performs actions done through wisdom but does not perform actions done through pride. Such bodily action performed through the body of wisdom is as follows: deception, guile, craftiness, and all manner of pretense are not committed. There is no aversion and no attachment. Ever living in pure conduct, and having undertaken diligence in the activities of the body, one is in harmony with awakening and does not harm oneself or others. Joined with the stream of the perfections and devoted to great compassion, one strives continuously for the benefit of sentient beings — such is the nature of bodily action that one is endowed with. Through being endowed with this rightly received Dharma, when one attains awakening, all the Tathāgata's bodily actions are preceded by wisdom and followed by wisdom — this is what is meant — and this quality is present therein.

Through having thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption that manifests all forms, and through mastery of the dhāraṇī of universal illumination, one displays through the body a Tathāgata of many colors, various colors, forms, shapes, and proportions, and one moves among every assembly gathered — gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (dri za), asuras, garuḍas (nam mkha' lding), kinnaras (mi'am ci), great serpents (mahoragas), Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, the world-guardians, brahmins, kṣatriyas, merchant families, commoners, monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, and assemblies of many hundreds and thousands of living beings — with immeasurable grace of deportment, with color, marks, and form that are settled, supreme, excellent, and exquisite of body. Manifesting such a body, endowed with all these qualities, one teaches words of Dharma to the assembly in all circumstances. One leads them to right reception. One offers them right praise. One brings them to right delight. Having rightly taught, rightly led to reception, rightly praised, and rightly delighted them, one then disappears from sight. Even upon disappearing, there is no awareness that one has gone. Gathered and seated in those very assemblies — whether speaking or not speaking — there is no awareness that one has come. Even gazing upon that one, one never feels satiated. Through what that one has taught, joy and supreme joy of the most vast and excellent kind is obtained. And one who delights in desire and

one directs and applies the mind so as to look upon no objects and no enjoyments whatsoever. When that one is no longer visible, a thirst arises to see and to hear. That thirst to see, and that longing to see, and that thirst to hear the Dharma, and that longing to hear the Dharma — all of these become causes for attaining the undefiled physical, verbal, and mental actions. This, dear daughter, is the thirteenth unshared quality of a Tathāgata's buddhahood.

Furthermore, dear daughter, when a bodhisattva practices the conduct of a bodhisattva, one performs actions wrought by wisdom but does not perform actions wrought by pride. In performing the verbal actions of wisdom, one does not engage in any deceit, guile, craftiness, or false pretense. One speaks truthfully and does not speak slander, harsh words, or idle chatter. One speaks words that are beneficial, words that are fitting, words of Dharma, and precisely those words — and by such words neither oneself nor others are tormented. One speaks words of genuine meaning, words that the buddhas have sanctioned, and by those words one satisfies all sentient beings. That one does not scorch or burn, for one is endowed with speech replete with wisdom, not speech replete with pride. Endowed with this rightly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening the Tathāgata bears what is called "all verbal actions preceded by wisdom and followed by wisdom" — and that is truly present in the Tathāgata. Having cultivated deeply the meditative absorption of the Source of Precious Gems, and being skilled in the dhāraṇī of the three circles, even without the Tathāgata uttering a single thing, there arises a sound that is melodious in every language and that satisfies the minds and intentions of the entire retinue. The voice and the sound and melody of all those Tathāgatas is endowed with meaning, endowed with Dharma, consonant with truth, not contradicting dependent origination, conducive to disenchantment and to freedom from attachment, leading to pacification, fruitful, and causal for everything from awakening all the way through to nirvāṇa. This, dear daughter, is the fourteenth unshared quality of a Tathāgata's buddhahood.

Furthermore, dear daughter, when a bodhisattva practices the conduct of a bodhisattva, one always and without interruption performs actions wrought by wisdom but does not perform actions wrought by pride. In performing the mental actions of wisdom, one does not engage in any deceit, guile, craftiness, or false pretense. One is free from covetousness, malice, and wrong view, and is endowed with right view. One abides in loving-kindness and compassion,

holds an even mind toward all sentient beings, and never forgets the awakening mind. One is endowed with a mind replete with wisdom, not a mind replete with pride. Endowed with this rightly undertaken Dharma, upon attaining awakening the Tathāgata bears what is called "all mental actions preceded by wisdom and followed by wisdom" — and that is truly present in the Tathāgata. Having deeply cultivated the meditative absorption in which the presently arisen buddhas are directly beheld, and being skilled in the dhāraṇī that is free from turbid grasping, the Tathāgata, through a single moment of mind, fully knows the minds of all sentient beings. Because all sentient beings are like magical illusions, and because the minds of all sentient beings are luminous by nature, through the equanimity of one's own mind one comprehends the equanimity of the minds of all sentient beings. And through the equanimity of the minds of all sentient beings one comprehends the equanimity of one's own mind. Because all bodies are like reflections, through the nature of reality of one's own body one comprehends the nature of reality of the bodies of all sentient beings.

Through the nature of reality of the bodies of all sentient beings one comprehends the nature of reality of one's own body. One's own body enters into and perfectly tames the bodies of all sentient beings. The bodies of all sentient beings enter into and perfectly tame one's own body. The bodies of all sentient beings are consecrated by the blessing of a buddha's body. That blessing cannot be shaken or stirred by any being of the world together with its gods, its māras, its Brahmās, its ascetics and brahmins, or the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras. This, dear daughter, is the fifteenth of the Tathāgata's unshared qualities of a buddha.

Dear daughter, furthermore, when a bodhisattva who is engaged in bodhisattva conduct hears of the unattached mind of the Tathāgatas of the past, they are filled with faith and confidence, free from doubt, free from wavering, free from timidity and universal timidity, free from dread and universal dread, and they have faith even in the inconceivable domain of a buddha. They have faith in the past Tathāgatas, those arhats, those perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, in the purity of their bodily actions and conduct, unattached and unobstructed, which pervaded every single world-realm without remainder. They have faith in the vocal actions of those past Tathāgatas — their voices and sounds pervading every world-realm, unattached, unobstructed, and inconceivable, everything encompassed by the buddha's speech, tones, and melodious voice, and the showing of every

limitless gateway of Dharma. They have faith in the mental actions of those past Tathāgatas — the utterly refined and complete discrimination of the karmic maturation of the actions of all times, all buddha-fields, all buddhas, all phenomena, all sentient beings, all bodhisattvas, all śrāvakas, all pratyekabuddhas, and all beings in every destiny. They are likewise filled with faith and confidence in the arrayed network of light-rays of those past Tathāgatas, unattached and unobstructed, free from doubt, free from wavering, free from timidity and universal timidity, free from dread and universal dread, and they have faith even in the inconceivable domain of a buddha. They lead other sentient beings as well to rightly grasp this very nature of aspiration.

One who is endowed with this properly received Dharma, upon attaining awakening, enters into what is called the attachment-free and obstruction-free seeing of the wisdom of the Tathāgatas of the past — and that is present in them. Through having deeply cultivated the meditative absorption (samādhi) called the Courageous Progress, and through mastery of the dhāraṇī endowed with splendor, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence the distinct names of the present and past Tathāgatas, or the distinct measures of their lifespans. Likewise, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence the past bodhisattvas, the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas, the sentient beings, the various forms of conduct engaged in by sentient beings, the experiences of the karmic maturation of the actions that produce those conducts, and likewise all the past eons — those eons that had buddhas, those that did not, and those eons in which any number of Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, arose. Likewise one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence the distinct names of all past world-realms: those that are afflicted, those that are purified, those that are small,

those that are large, those that are subtle, those that are coarse, those that have entered into the stream of atomic particles, those that are packed together, those that are aligned, those that are differentiated by cardinal and intermediate directions, and those that have entered into the stream of the distinctions of optical illusions — one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence all those past world-realms.

In that regard, the Tathāgata has no confusion with respect to all prophetic declarations, knowing everything through the Tathāgata's wisdom, as though

seeing it in the palm of one's hand with all five fingers. This, dear daughter, is the sixteenth unshared quality of the Tathāgata among the buddha-qualities.

Furthermore, dear daughter, when a bodhisattva is engaged in the bodhisattva's conduct, upon hearing of the unattached wisdom of the future Tathāgatas, that bodhisattva becomes devoted and confident, harbors no doubt, has no hesitation, is not timid, and does not become frightened or afraid, and is devoted even to the inconceivable domain of the buddhas. That bodhisattva is devoted to the bodies of those future Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — their utterly pure physical actions and physical conduct, unattached and unobstructed, pervading all limitless world-realms. That bodhisattva is devoted to all the inconceivable things pertaining to the verbal actions of those future Tathāgatas — their utterly unattached and unobstructed voices and sounds pervading all world-realms, the vocal expressions of the buddhas, their melodies, and their teaching of the measureless gateways of Dharma — pervading everything. That bodhisattva is devoted to the extremely refined discernment and discrimination, through the mental action of those future Tathāgatas, of the karmic maturation of all times, all buddha-fields, all buddhas, all phenomena, all sentient beings, all bodhisattvas, all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and all the destinies. That bodhisattva becomes fully devoted and confident with regard to the array of light-ray networks of those future Tathāgatas — unattached and unobstructed — harbors no doubt, has no hesitation, is not timid, and does not become frightened or afraid, and is devoted to the inconceivable domain of the buddhas. Other sentient beings too are led to embrace perfectly this very nature of such devotion. One who possesses this properly taken-up Dharma and attains awakening is said to enter, at the time of the future, into the seeing of the Tathāgata's wisdom — unattached and unimpeded — and that is present therein. Through the power of great compassion, the thoroughly cultivated meditative absorption of the perfectly noble aspiration, and mastery of the dhāraṇī called "the lion's full extension," one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence the distinct names and the distinct lifespans of all the Tathāgatas — the present Tathāgata and all the future Tathāgatas.

Likewise, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence all the future bodhisattvas, all the śrāvakas, all the pratyekabuddhas, all sentient beings, the conducts of sentient beings, the actions of sentient beings, the individual experiences of the karmic maturation

of sentient beings, and likewise all the future eons — those eons that will have buddhas, those that will not, and those eons in which any number of Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, will arise. Likewise, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence the distinct names of all the future world-realms,

those world-realms that are thoroughly afflicted, those that are thoroughly pure, those that are small, those that have become great, those that are subtle, those that are coarse, those that have entered into the succession of the infinitely fine particles, those that are compressed, those that are aligned, those in which directions and intermediate directions are clearly distinguished, and those that have entered into the succession of the differentiation of optical illusion — one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence all those future world-realms. Yet regarding all these, the Tathāgata has no confusion in any of his prophecies. By the wisdom of the Tathāgata, he knows all of them as clearly as one sees the palm of one's hand and its five fingers. This, then, is the seventeenth unshared quality of a Tathāgata, a buddha.

Moreover, young woman, when a bodhisattva is practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva and hears of the unobstructed wisdom of the presently arisen buddhas, he is inspired and filled with faith. He has no doubt, no wavering, no timidity, no fear, no trembling. He is inspired even with regard to the inconceivable domain of a buddha. He is inspired by the pure, unobstructed, and unimpeded physical actions and physical conduct of those presently arisen Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, as they range throughout all the countless world-realms. He is inspired by the vocal actions of those presently arisen Tathāgatas — the resonant sound pervading all world-realms, unobstructed and unimpeded, inconceivable in its totality — as they follow through in all things: the sounds and tones of a buddha, and the teaching of the measureless gateways of the Dharma. He is inspired by the mental actions of those presently arisen Tathāgatas as they perfectly and distinctly discern and differentiate, at all times, in all fields, with regard to all phenomena, all sentient beings, all bodhisattvas, all śrāvakas, all pratyekabuddhas, and the individual experiences of the karmic maturation of all destinies. He is also inspired and filled with faith with regard to the arrayed webs of light-rays of those presently arisen Tathāgatas — unobstructed and unimpeded — and has no doubt, no wavering, no timidity, no fear, no trembling. He is inspired even with regard to the inconceivable domain of a

buddha. He also leads other sentient beings to correctly hold to this very nature of such inspired devotion. One who possesses this correctly received Dharma, when attaining awakening, enters into the seeing of the wisdom of the presently arisen Tathāgatas — unobstructed and unimpeded in the present time. Such is what is called that, and it exists therein.

One who has thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption of the exceedingly pure and stainless mudrā, and is skilled in the dhāraṇī of the vajra maṇḍala — namely, a Tathāgata — cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence the distinct names and the varied lifespans of all the presently arisen Tathāgatas. Likewise, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence all the presently arisen bodhisattvas, all the śrāvakas, all the pratyekabuddhas, all sentient beings, the conducts of sentient beings, their actions, and the individual experiences of the karmic maturation of their actions. Likewise, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence all the present eons — those eons that have buddhas, those that do not, and those eons in which any number of Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, arise.

Likewise, one cannot reach the limit of comprehensively enumerating in sequence all the diverse names of all the presently arisen world-systems — those that are afflicted and those that are purified; those that are small and those that have become great; those that are subtle and those that are coarse; those that proceed in accordance with atomic analysis; those that are tightly packed together; those that are in conformity with one another; those in which the cardinal and intermediate directions are distinctly established; and those presently arisen world-systems that proceed in accordance with the distinctions of optical illusion. Regarding all of this, the Tathāgata is unconfused with respect to all that has been authoritatively taught, for the gnosis of the Tathāgata knows everything just as one sees the palm of one's hand and its five fingers. This, daughter, is the eighteenth unshared quality of the Buddha belonging to the Tathāgatas.

Upon attaining all of these — the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha and all the rest — what are they all? They are as follows.

The first is the unshared quality of the Buddha belonging to the Tathāgata: that the crown of the head cannot be seen, because he overshadows all and is supremely distinguished throughout. The second is that his body, being like a

healing medicine, pacifies the faults of sentient beings the instant it is seen. The third is that, being without any fault whatsoever, he is eminently distinguished from all his assemblies. The fourth is that, having fully attained fearlessness, he is without timidity. The fifth is that by right engagement he trains disciples who possess intention, who possess instruction, and who are consequently taught in conformity, without splitting the disciples. The sixth is that by dwelling in equality toward all sentient beings he trains disciples who are exceedingly disciplined. The seventh is that by being without hesitation in teaching the Dharma he is swift in eloquence. The eighth is that by being without digression he satisfies all sentient beings. The ninth is that he teaches the Dharma that is purposeful. The tenth is that by fully ripening the faculties of those to be tamed, with all his retinue single-pointedly minded, he sends forth the voice and sound of a buddha. The eleventh is that by his inconceivable miraculous display he is directly beheld by all the circles of his retinue. The twelfth is that because the Tathāgata's body is established with merit beyond measure, he is insatiable to look upon. The thirteenth is that through thorough comprehension he teaches the Dharma that bears fruit. The fourteenth is that with undisturbed conduct he gazes with the gaze of an elephant. The fifteenth is that with great enthusiasm he bears himself like a lion. The sixteenth is that his bodily action, with gnosis going before it, proceeds purposefully. The seventeenth is that his verbal action, with gnosis going before it, has mastery over speech. The eighteenth is that his mental action, with gnosis going before it, is endowed with vision in all directions. He is endowed with the manner worthy of being grasped by swift eloquence. He possesses the supreme gift and the supreme renown, having become the supreme field of giving without equal. Because he is penetrated through and through and touched at every limit by the dharmadhātu (basic space of phenomena), he is one whose merit knows no exhaustion. By virtue of his body of great might, his attainment of the ten powers, and his attainment of the supreme fearlessness, he is without constriction. By knowing the highest and the less-than-highest faculties of all sentient beings, he is unturned from producing happiness for sentient beings, undisturbed and without confusion. Being the Teacher of the entire world, he knows many Dharmas and sciences. Having thoroughly illuminated everything through the dharmakāya (truth body), he is of immeasurable lifespan, of utterly penetrating and limitless vision, endowed with learning, with service, with mindfulness, and with fruitful hearing. Through having comprehended the three times as one equalness, his wisdom is undisturbed. Because he speaks Dharma and speaks without error,

his discourse flows on continuously. Through having abandoned, without remainder, all non-virtuous qualities, he has thoroughly subdued all habitual tendencies.

The qualities of a buddha arise spontaneously, without a teacher; and through having fully penetrated every quality of a buddha without exception, he is omniscient — knowing all aspects. All these unmingled, exclusive qualities of a buddha are perfectly attained.

The fourth and final section.

Then the maiden Precious Jewel addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, through entering into which accumulations of roots of virtue in the past did these thirty-two marks of a great being manifest completely on the body of the Tathāgata?"

When she had spoken, the Blessed One declared to the maiden Precious Jewel: "Maiden, through entering into accumulations of roots of virtue — immeasurable and beyond all counting — these thirty-two marks of a great being were completely manifested on the body of the Tathāgata. I shall teach just a small portion of them.

"The mark of the Tathāgata — the great being's feet resting with perfect steadiness — was accomplished through steadfast commitment to former vows.

"The mark of the Tathāgata — the great being's feet bearing the wheel-sign on their soles — was accomplished through the former accumulation of many kinds of generosity.

"The broad heels and high insteps of the feet were accomplished through formerly never disparaging other sentient beings.

"The long fingers were accomplished through formerly guarding, protecting, and sheltering sentient beings with the Dharma.

"The webbing connecting the hands and feet was accomplished through formerly never dividing another's retinue of attendants.

"The tender and soft hands and feet were accomplished through formerly giving various kinds of garments.

"The seven prominent features were accomplished through formerly giving abundant food and drink.

"The limbs like those of the royal antelope Airāvata were accomplished through formerly embracing all the qualities of a buddha.

"The concealment of the private parts within a sheath was accomplished through formerly guarding secrets in speech and abandoning licentious conduct.

"The upper body like that of a lion was accomplished through formerly practicing wholesome actions in great measure and in full progression.

"The broad, fully developed chest was accomplished through formerly engaging rightly in wholesome qualities.

"The supremely rounded shoulders were accomplished through formerly giving relief to others through fearlessness.

"The arms reaching down without bending, and long, were accomplished through formerly rejoicing in doing whatever others needed done.

"The pure body was accomplished through formerly practicing the path of the ten wholesome actions of karma without ever wearying.

"The neck like a conch shell was accomplished through formerly giving many kinds of medicine to the sick.

"The cheeks like a lion's cheeks were accomplished through formerly perfecting conduct in the roots of virtue.

"The complete set of forty teeth was accomplished through formerly treating sentient beings with an equitable mind.

"The fine, even spacing of the teeth was accomplished through formerly reconciling sentient beings who were quarreling.

"The even teeth were accomplished through formerly giving pleasing jewels.

"The white canine teeth were accomplished through formerly guarding very carefully the actions of body, speech, and mind.

"The very long tongue was accomplished through formerly guarding truthful speech always and without exception.

"Possessing the supreme sense of taste was accomplished through formerly having given what was nourishing and pleasing in flavor, sustained by immeasurable merit.

"Possessing the voice of Brahmā and the tone of the kalaviṅka bird was accomplished through formerly speaking gentle words to sentient beings, speaking with controlled speech, and proclaiming words of joy.

"The deep blue eyes were accomplished through formerly abiding in loving-kindness and protecting all.

"The eyelashes like those of a noble cow were accomplished through formerly having intention free from deceit.

"The very white hair between the eyebrows was accomplished through formerly praising those who were worthy of praise.

"Possessing the uṣṇīṣa crown protrusion on the head was accomplished through formerly venerating and bowing to one's teachers."

"The fine, thin skin was accomplished through formerly having a mind serviceable for gathering the Dharma correctly.

"The golden complexion was accomplished through formerly giving pleasing garments and bedding.

"The single hair growing from each pore was accomplished through formerly having completely abandoned restless busyness.

"The tips of the body hair curling to the right was accomplished through formerly holding in harmony the instructions of one's preceptors, teachers, and spiritual friends.

"The head hair blue like the indranīla gem was accomplished through formerly showing loving care for all living creatures and casting aside clubs, weapons, and stones.

"The body as proportioned as a nyagrodha tree was accomplished through formerly applying oneself to meditative absorption, and encouraging other sentient beings likewise to do so.

"This beautiful body of the Tathāgata, adorned in all its parts with the great marks of a great being, was accomplished through formerly creating images of the Tathāgata, repairing damaged stūpas, relieving those who were afraid, and reconciling sentient beings who were in discord. O daughter, it was through practicing these immeasurable, incalculable roots of virtue that the thirty-two marks of a great being were fully accomplished on the body of the Tathāgata."

Then the maiden Ratnā addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how wonderful it is that the Tathāgata, drawing upon the roots of virtue that arose from causes cultivated in the past, has set forth all the qualities of a buddha!"

When she had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied to the maiden Ratnā in these words: "O daughter, that is indeed so. O daughter, all the qualities of a buddha have been taught from this teaching. O daughter, those bodhisattvas who hear this teaching — which sets forth all the qualities of a buddha arising from the roots of virtue cultivated by the Tathāgata in former times — and who, upon hearing it, realise it as suchness: regard those bodhisattvas as having found it, as having found it well, as those who will come to be endowed with all the supreme aspects of every quality of a buddha."

When the Blessed One taught this chapter of the Dharma-door that sets forth the Tathāgata's powers, fearlessness, the unshared qualities of a buddha, and the marks in full, all the world-realms of the ten directions shook mightily, suffused with a great radiance, and immeasurable, incalculable sentient beings aroused the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. Twenty-five thousand bodhisattvas gave rise to the acceptance of the birthlessness of phenomena. From the sky above, thousands of gods rained down a shower of flowers and played sweet music, having heard this chapter of the Dharma-door that sets forth the Tathāgata's powers, fearlessness, the unshared qualities of a buddha, and the marks in full. And those sentient beings who heard it, who had faith and confidence in it, who upheld it and realised it as suchness — they will never come to possess inferior roots of virtue. Just as the present Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha does, so too will they roar the lion's roar before the world together with its gods.

And why is that? Blessed One, this teaching will not enter the hearts of those sentient beings who are of lesser aspiration and who do not abide in diligent effort, but it will enter the hearts of those whose conduct is perfectly pure. Blessed One, those sentient beings who have conduct that is perfectly pure and who practice the Dharma will come to rejoice in this teaching, to have it settle in their minds, and to feel great delight in it — this was proclaimed, again and again proclaimed.

Then the girl Ratnavatī addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Tathāgata has proclaimed all the qualities of buddhahood that arise from the roots of virtue cultivated in former lives.

Blessed One, what is the practice of Dharma by which a bodhisattva will come to practice the Dharma? Blessed One, please explain well the practice of Dharma for bodhisattvas."

When she had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the girl Ratnavatī:

"Daughter, the following is the practice of Dharma: purity of intention; steadfast affection; gratitude; knowing how to repay kindness; possessing tenderness; not abandoning those who have taken refuge; bearing with and accepting those who are lowly; giving away what is difficult to give; acting for the benefit of others; having a mind oriented toward benefiting them; guarding against bad conduct; thinking with certainty about the Dharma; protecting the Dharma in every way; longing for the Dharma; guarding the sacred Dharma; solitude; delight in being alone; not becoming weary of forest dwellings; fully appreciating the qualities of forest dwellings; completely abandoning socializing and commotion; looking after sentient beings; seeing what is mistaken for what it is; applying oneself to loving-kindness; entering into great compassion; delighting in the Dharma through joy and taking supreme delight in it; settling the mind in meditative concentration on equanimity; engaging other sentient beings in the awakening mind; speaking the praises of the Great Vehicle; taking up and carrying one's burden; not letting the mind become timid; knowing the right measure of what is suitable; being without feeling for sense impressions; not desiring evil; being free of jealousy; abandoning the pursuit of desirable things; understanding what is fitting for the noble lineage; gathering refined qualities and requisites; being free of quarreling; being free of dispute; being free of malice; being free of anger; possessing patience; being content; thoroughly understanding what causes do; having conviction in the karmic maturation of actions; faith; moral discipline; learning; generosity; having conscience; having a sense of shame; pursuing the wealth of wisdom; showing respect for one's teacher; relying on a spiritual friend; being easy to instruct; being receptive and harmonious; being free of pride; bowing down; humility of mind; not praising oneself; not disparaging others; not proclaiming one's own good qualities; not denigrating others' good qualities; sweeping away the dust of attachment; thoroughly abandoning the thorn of aversion; being free from the dark obscurity of delusion; crushing pride; being diligent in one's deportment and conduct; attending to the Dharma with delight and joy and supreme delight; having unwavering confidence in the Buddha; being devoted to the Dharma; holding the Saṅgha as one would a teacher; generosity; self-restraint; observance of

vows; going forth from home life; abiding in the holy life of celibacy; being unmoved by gain and loss, fame and obscurity, praise and blame, pleasure and pain; thoroughly transcending the ways of the world; viewing friends and enemies with equal regard; speaking directly and openly; a smiling countenance; being free of frowns; being free of pretense; being free of flattery; being free of deception; being free of cunning; being genuine and unartificial; having a thoroughly pure intention; generosity; pleasant speech; working for the benefit of others; harmony of purpose; and the very nature of bringing joy."

Recollection of the Buddha; recollection of the Dharma; recollection of the Saṅgha; recollection of giving; recollection of moral discipline; recollection of the gods; perfectly completing the perfections of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom; accomplishing skillful means; thoroughly purifying all roots of virtue; purifying the body, speech, and mind of sentient beings; guarding the path of the ten virtuous actions; being convinced of impermanence, suffering, selflessness, the absence of sentient beings, the absence of a life-force, the absence of a sustaining principle, and the absence of a person; resolving upon emptiness; abiding in the signless; knowing the wishless; not dwelling in the three realms; the four establishments of mindfulness; the four right abandonments; the four bases of miraculous power; the faculties; the powers; the limbs of awakening; entering the path; and discerning through calm abiding and insight — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Moreover, young woman, the practice of the Dharma is this: not engaging with the eye; not engaging with form; not engaging with the signs of form; not engaging with the ear; not engaging with sound; not engaging with the signs of sound; not engaging with the nose; not engaging with smell; not engaging with the signs of smell; not engaging with the tongue; not engaging with taste; not engaging with the signs of taste; not engaging with the body; not engaging with touch; not engaging with the signs of touch; not engaging with the mind; not engaging with phenomena; not engaging with the signs of phenomena — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Not engaging with form; not engaging with the signs of form; not engaging with the impermanence of form; not engaging with the suffering of form; not engaging with the selflessness of form; not engaging with the peace of form; not engaging with the emptiness of form; not engaging with the signlessness of form; not engaging with the wishlessness of form; not engaging with the

non-fabrication of form; not engaging with the seclusion of form; not engaging with the intrinsic nature of form; not engaging with the suchness of form; not engaging with the unborn nature of form; not engaging with the non-arising of form; not engaging with form's having no ground; not engaging with form's having no abiding place; not engaging with the suchness of form — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Likewise, not engaging with feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Not engaging with the impermanence of consciousness; not engaging with the suffering of consciousness; not engaging with the selflessness of consciousness; not engaging with the peace of consciousness; not engaging with the emptiness of consciousness; not engaging with the signlessness of consciousness; not engaging with the wishlessness of consciousness; not engaging with the non-fabrication of consciousness; not engaging with the seclusion of consciousness; not engaging with the intrinsic nature of consciousness; not engaging with the suchness of consciousness; not engaging with the unborn nature of consciousness; not engaging with the non-arising of consciousness; not engaging with consciousness having no ground; not engaging with consciousness having no abiding place; not engaging with the suchness of consciousness — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Not engaging with the elements;

Not engaging with the sense bases; not engaging with desire, form, and the formless; and where there is no engagement and no full engagement — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Where there is no engagement and no thorough engagement; no going; no abiding; no entering in; where there is no engaging with mind, mentation, and consciousness; no engaging with seeing, hearing, and discerning; no engaging with consciousness; no engaging with desire and formations; where there is no engaging with phenomena and no engaging with what is not phenomena; no engaging with duality; no engaging with multiplicity; no engaging with past and future; no engaging with what arises in the present; and where there is no engaging with the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases — this is the practice of the Dharma.

Where there is no engaging with the conceit of defilement and of purification; no engaging with the whole and with substances; no engaging with self,

sentient being, life-force, nourishment, person, individual, one born of semen, one who grasps at a seed, and superimposition; no engaging with arising, ceasing, and abiding; no engaging with the grasping at "I" and the grasping at "mine"; no engaging with permanence and annihilation; no engaging with extreme-grasping views; no engaging with attachment to a middle — and the ground or non-ground of the essential nature of self and phenomena, the ground of the intrinsic nature of phenomena, the ground of all phenomena, the ground of emptiness and non-emptiness, the ground of firm abiding, and the immovability of all phenomena, the non-abiding, the absence of abiding place, the absence of essential nature, the absence of movement, the absence of conceptual elaboration, the absence of taking up, the absence of casting away, the absence of assertion, the absence of grasping — and where one knows this Dharma and yet has not even a conceit of knowing it: this is called knowing what is true, knowing the real, knowing suchness, knowing the Dharma.

O daughter, a bodhisattva who has fully comprehended all phenomena in this way, and who then moves through saṃsāra for the sake of taming other sentient beings while remaining utterly unmoved from the dharmatā of nirvāṇa — this is the supreme and genuine conduct of a bodhisattva.

When this teaching on the practice of the Dharma was set forth, eight thousand bodhisattvas attained the supreme forbearance (kṣānti).

Then the daughter Precious Jewel offered the Blessed One a hundred thousand garlands of pearl and spoke these words: "Blessed One, a bodhisattva who strives in this practice of the Dharma strives in all the qualities of a buddha. And the prophecy for such a one is this: seated at the seat of awakening, having vanquished māra and the opposing forces, one shall be seen sealed with the seal of non-return."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said to the daughter Precious Jewel: "O daughter, do you know the seal of non-return for bodhisattvas?"

Thereupon the daughter Precious Jewel spoke these verses to the venerable Śāradvatīputra:

One who has realized with perfect evenness
the dharmadhātu and the realm of sentient beings,
and who understands the absence of duality —
that one bears the seal of non-return.

Those who have realized with equal understanding
the buddhas of the past, those of the present,
and those yet to come — each and all —
as equal in the basic space of phenomena:
they turn back no more.

One who has thoroughly comprehended
the conditioned elements and
the unconditioned elements
as empty by virtue of their seclusion —
that one turns back no more.

The past's beginning is without end,
and its measure is unapprehended.
One who has taken this to heart
in a single instant of mind turns back no more.

Whatever phenomena of the worldly
are designated as the domains of conduct —
one who comprehends these through wisdom
turns back no more.

However many are the domains of Māra,
one who knows those and the domains of the buddhas
to be non-dual —
that one has been sealed with this seal.

Whatever attachment, aversion, and delusion,
whatever afflictions are without limit —
one who understands that these arise
from the root of conceptual thought turns back no more.

Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa,
and the peace that is awakening —
one who has taken to heart that these are not different
but fully equal turns back no more.

The aggregates are as awakening itself;
the aggregates and awakening are non-dual.
Understanding these to be equal, like a magical illusion,
those who are free from conceptual thought are wise.

Moreover, the four elements
are the element of space itself.
One who has taken to heart
that there is nothing to apprehend
has been truly sealed with this seal.

The eye is awakening, and yet not awakening —
the buddhas have declared it to be empty.
Just as with the eye, so too awakening:
they are made equal by being always equal.

And so it is with all the sense sources (āyatanas):
always empty and equal to awakening.
Those who have thoroughly understood this manner
have been sealed with that seal.

One who fully knows
that all sentient beings' minds
are comprehended in a single mind —
without doubt, that one will not turn back from perfect awakening.

The perfections (pāramitās) of the faculties of all sentient beings —
the highest, the middling, and the lowest —
those, too, are non-returners.

This is unobstructed eloquence.
Even were one to speak of it continuously, without interruption,
recounting it for tens of millions of aeons,
the praise of it would not be exhausted.

Space itself may reach its end;
the wind may be caught in a snare —
but the eloquence of these ones
could never be exhausted by the world.

Their mind is unconfused,
and what is heard by them is never wasted.
The dhāraṇī that retains all phenomena
is the sphere of their activity.

Whatever sacred Dharma has been taught
by the guides of all ten directions —
those who have attained dhāraṇī hold all of it

through mindfulness and understanding.

Through thorough training in dhāraṇī,
they will be able, when asked,
to teach the Dharma they have heard
from the protectors throughout tens of millions of past aeons.

Such, then, is the dhāraṇī of those who do not turn back;
such, too, is their eloquence;
and such is their wisdom.

Phenomena are sealed with the seal of emptiness —
without karmic maturation, without removal.
Those who have been sealed with the seal of emptiness
are shown to be non-returners.

Phenomena sealed with the seal of space
are without intrinsic arising.
One who has thoroughly penetrated the extreme of this
and has been sealed with that seal turns back no more.

Phenomena arise in dependence;
there is no phenomenon without a cause.
Whatever phenomena arise from causes —
the defining mark of those is cessation.

The defining mark of all phenomena
is the defining mark of equality with space.
Those who have been sealed with such a seal —
a seal bearing just such a defining mark — turn back no more.

Those who do not turn back
can fully reveal, in a single instant of mind,
the conduct of all sentient beings,
their forms, their ways of moving, and the times.

The accumulation of their generosity is without limit,
their merit inexhaustible and constant.
If it were to take a single taste,
it would fill even the expanse of space.

Their moral discipline is great indeed —
it is a source from which the moral discipline of the buddhas flows,

immeasurable and boundless,
like the expanse of space.

The moral discipline of all sentient beings,
of śrāvakas,
and of each of the Victors —
does not equal even a sixteenth part of the moral discipline of the
non-returns.

Their patience is inexhaustible,
generated through birthlessness.
Patience, inexhaustible and perfect,
is what makes one a non-returner.

Their diligence is great indeed —
genuine effort, immeasurable,
and energy without measure,
satisfying all sentient beings.

Their meditative support is in constant equipoise,
free from distraction and thoroughly restrained.
Even while performing all their activities,
they do not stir from that equipoise.

Through wisdom they have attained non-attachment,
purifying the habitual tendencies of views.
They have perfectly attained the domain of the buddhas
and have purified their excellent fields.

Sealed by the buddhas' seal,
they have attained the perfection of primordial wisdom.
They train most thoroughly in the great skillful means
and engage in the conduct of awakening.

Those who ripen all sentient beings
have a domain that is boundless.
Whatever their conduct, whatever their thought —
there is no knowing their activity.

Arhats, pratyekabuddhas,
māras, non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), and all others —
the domain of those ones, which is immeasurable,

they are not able to know.

Their meditative concentration, their miraculous powers,
and their emanations are not accompanied by deliberate formations.
As heroes, in a manner spontaneously accomplished,
they engage in all those activities.

They display their lives, their entering into existence, their passing away,
the seat of awakening (bodhimaṇḍa),
the great turning of the wheel of Dharma,
and the form of a buddha.

Present before all buddhas,
shining forth in every pure land,
clear and brilliant as the sun and moon —
such ones are endowed with a quality equal to space.

In accordance with the inclination of whichever vehicle,
they even show nirvāṇa —
yet the seal of non-return, whatever it is,
that seal is not cast away.

To whatever extent space pervades,
to that same extent their primordial wisdom pervades.
That they do not turn back from that seal —
this the buddhas know.

When this seal of non-return had been proclaimed, the great trichiliocosm
shook and trembled. Five thousand bodhisattvas were then prophesied with
the seal of non-return. The Blessed One also addressed the maiden Precious
Jewel with the words: "Excellent! Excellent! O maiden, you have spoken well in
thus revealing the mark of non-return for the bodhisattvas."

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One with these words:
"Blessed One, from this kind of confidence displayed by the maiden Precious
Jewel, she has surely been sealed with the seal of non-return — of that there is
no doubt. Blessed One, there is no one capable of teaching such a Dharma as
this without having realized it directly." The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, it
is so, just as you have said. The maiden Precious Jewel has been sealed with
the seal of non-return, has thoroughly attained patience, and has reached the
depths of the Great Vehicle."

Then the maiden Precious Jewel addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, why is the Great Vehicle called the Great Vehicle?" When she had asked this, the Blessed One spoke to the maiden Precious Jewel as follows:

"Maiden, the Great Vehicle is vast because it opens a way for all sentient beings. Because it reveals all roots of virtue in their entirety, this vehicle is without obscuration. Because it is free from the dense darkness of the gloom of afflictions, this vehicle is without stain. Because it possesses the defining characteristic of a gateway to complete liberation in all respects, this vehicle is fully luminous. Because it has never been afflicted by defilement from the very beginning, this vehicle is clear light. Because it is free from habitual tendencies, this vehicle is utterly pure.

Because the aggregate of moral discipline is perfectly guarded, this vehicle is wholly pure. Because the aggregate of meditative absorption is thoroughly examined, this vehicle is excellently and evenly established. Because it is well examined through the aggregate of wisdom, this vehicle is undefiled. Because the aggregate of liberation is made perfectly white, this vehicle is definitively liberated. Because the wisdom-vision of liberation is thoroughly realized, this vehicle reveals the equality of all phenomena. Because it is thoroughly held by the ten powers, this vehicle is indomitable. Because it roars the lion's roar with the four fearlessnesses, this vehicle is without fear. Because it is thoroughly held by the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, this vehicle moves with blessing that meets no obstacle.

Because of the mind of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, this vehicle is impartial. Because it cuts down every assault of māras and adversaries in accordance with the Dharma, this vehicle decisively vanquishes through Dharma consonant with Dharma. By utterly conquering all the forces of māra, this vehicle becomes the destroyer of those forces. This vehicle thoroughly pacifies the māra of afflictions. This vehicle thoroughly knows the māra of the aggregates. This vehicle is free from the māra of the lord of death. This vehicle fully abandons the māra of the divine son.

Because the perfection of generosity is completely fulfilled, this vehicle is endowed with abundance. Because the perfection of moral discipline is completely fulfilled, this vehicle is free from all torment. Because the perfection of patience is completely fulfilled, this vehicle has overcome māras and adversaries. Because the perfection of diligence is completely fulfilled, this vehicle is of unbreakable stability. Because it is free from all that is

improper and all slackness, this vehicle is without fault. Because the perfection of meditative concentration is completely fulfilled, this vehicle is free from the fault of mental torment. This vehicle proceeds to the abode of all excellent paths. Because the perfection of wisdom is completely fulfilled, this vehicle distinctly and rightly knows skillfulness in all things, the gnosis that comprehends all things, all worldly phenomena, and all supramundane phenomena.

Because skillful means is completely fulfilled, this vehicle arises fittingly through all vehicles. By the manner of proceeding of nirvāṇa, this vehicle has neither coming nor going. Because it is adorned with the noble eightfold path, this vehicle proceeds in ease. Because it is endowed with the force of the winds of calm abiding and insight, this vehicle moves through blessing. Because no adversary whatsoever can find it to challenge, this vehicle is thoroughly encircled by the retinue of the faculties, the powers, and the factors of awakening. Because it surveys all buddha-fields with ease, this vehicle moves on the four bases of miraculous power. Because it is endowed with all virtuous phenomena, this vehicle is excellently and evenly established in right abandonment. Because it is never interrupted, this vehicle has thoroughly purified the close placement of mindfulness. Because undefiled phenomena arrive through it, this vehicle has issued forth from the three realms. By attaining the appearance of the conditioned realm, this vehicle renders the conditioned realm unconditioned. Because it does not desire the vehicles of any śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha, this vehicle steers without forgetting the awakening mind and guides it well.

Because the crown of the head cannot be seen from above, this vehicle is supremely exalted. This vehicle is adorned with the accumulation of merit. This vehicle, through the accumulation of wisdom, thoroughly knows the intentions of sentient beings. Because it performs an offering of sacrifice that is without end, this vehicle is an open door. Because the wisdom of all buddhas is equal, this vehicle is of one taste. Because its renown has spread in all ten directions, this vehicle is proclaimed. Because of the excellent karma it has performed, this vehicle is honored by all the gods. Because its praise is boundless, this vehicle is celebrated by Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, and all the world-protectors. Because generosity comes first, this vehicle gives giving to those who are miserly. Because it is thoroughly permeated by great compassion, this vehicle gives ethical conduct to those of degenerate behavior. Because it harbors no mind of anger toward any sentient

being, this vehicle gives patience to those who have minds intent on harm. Because it never casts aside firm armor, this vehicle gives diligence to those who are lazy. Because the mind is tamed, peaceful, and workable, this vehicle gives meditative concentration to those whose minds are distracted. Because it brings all sentient beings into connection with learning, this vehicle gives wisdom to those whose wisdom is defective. Because it performs no evil whatsoever, this vehicle accomplishes all happiness and clears away all suffering. This vehicle, through non-attached wisdom, manifests the wisdom of the buddhas and non-attached wisdom everywhere, and has reached the crown of all vehicles. Therefore it is called the Great Vehicle.

When this enumeration of Dharma was taught, twelve thousand living beings generated the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening and said: "We too have entered the Great Vehicle, and we will establish in this Great Vehicle as many sentient beings as there are."

Then the daughter Ratnā addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what are the impediments to the Great Vehicle that prevent one from swiftly and certainly attaining omniscience?" And when she had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the daughter Ratnā: "Daughter, there are thirty-two impediments to the Great Vehicle, and by these impediments one does not swiftly and certainly attain omniscience. What are the thirty-two? They are as follows: desiring the vehicle of the śrāvakas; desiring the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas; aspiring to become Śakra or Brahmā; abiding in existence and practicing the holy life for the sake of rebirth; being attached to a single root of virtue; being miserly regarding one's possessions and wealth; not giving equally to sentient beings; being lax in ethical conduct; not guarding the awakening mind; allowing tendencies of ill will and anger to settle in; becoming disheartened and forgetful; not seeking learning; lacking investigation; being ignoble; letting pride grow upon pride; having thoroughly impure actions of body, speech, and mind; not protecting the holy Dharma; concealing the Dharma from one's teacher; abandoning the means of gathering; giving up those things that would lead to genuine joy; relying on evil companions; not dedicating to awakening, which is discordant with the third collection; being arrogant on account of a slight root of virtue; falling into a mind that is without skillful means; speaking abroad and yet not uttering praise of the Three Jewels; intending to harm bodhisattvas; rejecting Dharma that has not been heard before; not taking to heart the deeds of māra; holding onto worldly secret words that lead astray;

not ripening sentient beings, and being weary of saṃsāra — these thirty-two daughters are the genuine obstacles to the Great Vehicle, and through these obstacles one will not swiftly and certainly arrive at omniscience. Yet, dear daughter, to whatever extent one obstructs the qualities of the Great Vehicle, the obstacles are equally great. Why is that? To whatever extent there are faults in conditioned things, the obstacles to the Great Vehicle are equally great. To whatever extent there are qualities of nirvāṇa, the praises and qualities of the Great Vehicle are equally great. To whatever extent there are praises and qualities of the Great Vehicle, the Tathāgata's knowledge of the secondary mental afflictions is equally extensive — and all of that constitutes an obstacle to the Great Vehicle. To whatever extent the Tathāgata fully knows the qualities of buddhahood, the praises and qualities of the Great Vehicle are equally vast.

Therefore, dear daughter, a bodhisattva, a great being, must by all means thoroughly abandon those Dharmas that have become afflictions to the Great Vehicle, and must rely upon, cultivate, and repeatedly practice those Dharmas through which the Great Vehicle becomes fully purified. What, then, are those Dharmas through which the Great Vehicle becomes fully purified? Dear daughter, these thirty-two Dharmas are those through which the Great Vehicle becomes fully purified. What are the thirty-two? They are as follows:

Becoming a spiritual friend to all sentient beings without being asked; having no envy toward the deeds of others; holding firm resolve toward all collections of roots of virtue; having no discouragement in completing all tasks; having an undisturbed mind through pure intention; having a body fully purified through non-conceptuality in all conduct; having speech fully purified by acting in accordance with whatever one has said; having a mind fully purified by not abandoning the awakening mind; having generosity fully purified by not hoping for a return; having moral discipline fully purified by thoroughly guarding against all bad behavior; having patience fully purified by not regarding body and life as precious; having diligence fully purified by completing the ten powers and four fearlessnesses; having meditative concentration fully purified by not being overwhelmed by any affliction; having wisdom fully purified by completely vanquishing all habitual tendencies; abandoning all the deeds of māra through intention; remaining firm in one's commitment by performing ablutions with one's body face down; not abandoning the means of gathering by ripening sentient beings; repaying the kindness done to the buddhas by fully guarding the holy Dharma; having no

weariness by completing the Dharmas conducive to awakening; being insatiable in learning so as to perfect wisdom and gnosis; being unattached to higher distinctions once one has understood them; listening without arrogance so that one is not seen as looking down upon others; finding no contradiction with any Dharma whatsoever, through clearly perceiving the assembly of causes and conditions; being without poverty, so as to fully attain the seven noble treasures; having sovereignty over oneself, being self-reliant and no one's servant; pacifying the afflictions of all sentient beings through the superknowledges accomplished by gathering merit and gnosis; displaying the gateways to the three doors of liberation — emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness — by practicing calm abiding and insight through accomplishing the Tathāgata's knowledge and liberation;

through fully comprehending the measure of all sentient beings by means of gnosis, bringing inner peace; through knowing exhaustion and non-arising by means of patient acceptance of the doctrine of non-arising; and being prophesied to abide earnestly, making the essential point of all phenomena — daughter, these thirty-two qualities are what purify the Great Vehicle.

When this enumeration of the Dharma of the chapter on purifying the Great Vehicle was taught, seventy-two thousand living beings — gods and humans — aroused the mind aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Twenty thousand bodhisattvas attained patient acceptance of the doctrine of non-arising. From the sky above, a hundred thousand gods raised a clamor and a great cry, scattered flowers, and struck up celestial music. Then they made this solemn proclamation: all those sentient beings who, upon hearing this chapter of the Dharma gateway that teaches the qualities and praises of the Great Vehicle, hear it with faith, and having heard it with faith take it up and hold it, and practice it earnestly, will without doubt abide in the qualities of a buddha. Thus was this solemn declaration made.

Then Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā lord of the Akaṇiṣṭha realm, and the four great kings addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, how marvelous that this enumeration of the Dharma has been taught — so rich in manifold meanings, pacifying the afflictive obscurations, endowed with definitive meaning, vanquishing māras and adversaries, thoroughly taming all opposing forces, fully upholding all the qualities of a buddha, utterly infallible, and setting forth words of certainty that are profound. Blessed One, we too shall take up and hold this enumeration of the Dharma. Wherever a Dharma-teacher carries this enumeration of the Dharma, wherever it is

treasured up, wherever it appears as a written volume — all gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas who have faith in this enumeration of the Dharma and come to hold it, we shall embrace them with all our protection. As for those who seek opportunities through hostile minds to harm these Dharma-teachers in any way, we shall utterly repel them.

Then the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to Śakra, to Brahmā lord of Akaṇiṣṭha, and to the four world-protectors: Friends, it is excellent, excellent, that you have pledged to fully embrace the Dharma-teachers. By fully embracing the Dharma-teachers, friends, you are fully embracing the sacred Dharma. By fully embracing the sacred Dharma, you have fully embraced all sentient beings.

Then the Blessed One addressed the Venerable Ānanda: Ānanda, take up, memorize, master, and teach to others at length this enumeration of the Dharma, which the daughter Ratnā asked for out of reverence for the sacred Dharma. Ānanda, a bodhisattva who is devoted to generosity and for a thousand aeons practices giving with patience that is still oriented toward an object — even that is surpassed in merit by another bodhisattva who enters into this enumeration of the Dharma, teaches it to others, abides in great compassion with the aim of bringing sentient beings to complete liberation, and who, endowed with great loving-kindness and with the intention fixed on the Dharma, fully enters into patient acceptance. That one's merit grows far greater, and in just this way one swiftly and certainly emerges into the Great Vehicle.

When this was declared, the Venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One: Blessed One, if I am to take up this enumeration of the Dharma, Blessed One, what is the name of this enumeration of the Dharma, and how should I take it up?

The Blessed One declared: Ānanda, therefore take up this enumeration of the Dharma under the name "The Chapter on the Gateway to Expertise in Truth, Dharma, Meaning, and Discipline." Take it up also under the name "Teaching the Arousal of the Awakening Mind Toward Boundless Precious Qualities," and under the name "Teaching the Distinction of the Powers of the Tathāgata, His Fearlessness, the Unshared Qualities of a Buddha, and His Major Marks," and under the name "The Complete Dharma-Practice of a Bodhisattva," and under the name "Teaching the Seal of Irreversibility," and under the name "The Oral Instructions of the Great Vehicle," and under the name "The Chapter on Discipline," and take it up also under the name "The Questions of the Maiden

Ratnā."

Ānanda, if you uphold this chapter on the gateway to the Dharma and teach it to others as well, you will obtain the light of Dharma with regard to immeasurable qualities of virtue, and you will come to abide close to sentient beings through the activity of a buddha. Why is that? Because the awakening of all the Blessed Buddhas of the past, the future, and the present is gathered together right here.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the Venerable Ānanda, the maiden Ratnā, and the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and offered heartfelt praise at what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the noble Great Vehicle sūtra entitled "The Oral Instructions of the Great Vehicle."

Translated by the Indian masters Jinamitra, Dānaśīla, and the chief translator, the monk Ye shes sde, along with others, and established in final form.

Translator's Notes

- The epithets of the bodhisattvas listed toward the end are rendered according to their Tibetan semantic content rather than any recoverable Sanskrit name, as these names do not correspond to well-known figures with standard Sanskrit attestations. The rendering of "Essence of Vairocana" for Vairocana Snying po follows the literal meaning.

The phrase rendered "cloister of the assembly adorned with precious things, the domain of the Tathāgatas" describes an elaborate celestial or transformed setting within Rājagṛha; the compound is dense and its exact architectural referent is not entirely certain, but the translation preserves the key elements as they appear in the Tibetan.

- The passage opens with a genitive absolute phrase connecting back to the preceding list of bodhisattvas; the rendering "and together with the inexpressible ones" is a minimal bridging clause to complete that syntactic thread.

The phrase rendered "individual perfect knowledges" translates the standard term for the four unobstructed knowledges or pratisamvids, here signalled by "so so yang dag par rig pa," a recognized Mahāyāna technical category.

The expression "palace built of pearl garlands abides and is arrayed upon the crown" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; the image is of a canopy or tower of pearl strands arching over the heads of the Tathāgata and all bodhisattvas, and the girl's aspiration is that this act of offering generate the condition for their full awakening — the syntax is deliberately inclusive of both the Tathāgata and the bodhisattvas, which is unusual but preserved faithfully.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, cutting off after a list of flower names. The translation preserves this incompleteness faithfully. The flower "□□□□□□□□" corresponds to Sanskrit pāriśāka or pārijāta, a celestial flower associated with the heaven of the thirty-three gods. The phrase "□□□□□□□□□□" likely refers to saffron flowers or a similar fragrant bloom,

though the precise identification of this Tibetan floral term admits some uncertainty. The term "ལྷ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་མོ་" rendered as "guardian of the world" corresponds to Sanskrit lokapāla; "ལྷ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་མོ་" rendered as "the Great Lord" corresponds to Sanskrit Maheśvara, an epithet of Śiva, here kept distinct from the earlier "Great God" rendering to reflect the slightly different Tibetan form, though they refer to the same deity.

- The phrase rendered as "the chapter on the assembly" translates the Tibetan term for a section of scripture dealing with a gathered assembly or congregation. This may refer to a specific structural division of the larger sūtra in which this passage appears; the precise referent is slightly uncertain but does not affect the doctrinal meaning.

The final question, "what is it that makes bodhisattvas speakers of truth," is literally "in what way are bodhisattvas those who speak truth," and opens what appears to be a formal doctrinal inquiry. The phrasing has been rendered to preserve that interrogative structure naturally for oral delivery.

- The phrase rendered "the sharpness of diligence" translates a triad of nouns but the Tibetan text as presented lists "steadfastness, strength, and the sharpness of diligence" as only three items where "four qualities" are announced. The text may contain a lacuna or the count may be applied loosely, a pattern also found in the second grouping where "four qualities" are then given as four distinct items. This discrepancy is noted here rather than smoothed over silently.
- The phrase rendered "the aspect of being unobjectified" translates a term meaning that the bodhisattva's truthful speech does not take a referential object as its basis in the conventional grasping sense — a subtle Madhyamaka resonance that the text leaves implicit here.

The closing line, literally "apply as above," is a standard Tibetan textual abbreviation indicating that the structural formula of vow and truth just established for each perfection continues to be applied. It has been rendered as an explicit bridging sentence for the listener's clarity.

- The name "Khri" for the bodhisattva who attains forbearance follows the preceding passage's established rendering; the Tibetan "ཁྱིའོ་" is a genitive form of a proper name, and its identification should remain consistent with prior context.

The phrase rendered "victory-crest of the Dharma" for "旂常道勝之旗" follows the standard military-banner imagery of the passage; "tog" here denotes the ornamental finial or crest atop a standard.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation preserves this open-ended form faithfully.

- The term rendered "four individual perfect knowledges" translates ལྔ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཀློང་ལྔ་པ་ལྟོགས་པ་ལྔ་པ་ལྟོགས་པ་ལྔ་པ་ལྟོགས་པ་, corresponding to the Sanskrit pratisamvid, the four discriminating knowledges or analytical insights. The Tibetan here uses the verb ལྟོགས་པ་ meaning to explain or expound, which has been rendered "explaining."

[illegible]

- The phrase rendered "not characterized by penetration" translates a term whose literal meaning is "the defining mark of piercing or penetrating." In context it appears to negate the vajra's characteristic quality of indestructible penetration, forming a pair with "not a vajra" immediately before it. The doctrinal point is that Dharma transcends even the vajra metaphor of indestructibility.

The phrase "neither other-and-not-other" renders a Tibetan expression that appears to negate simultaneously both the position of otherness and the combined negation of otherness — a tetralemma-style closure consistent with Madhyamaka usage.

- The phrase rendered "signlessness and wishlessness" represents two of the three doors of liberation: emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness. The Tibetan here lists only the latter two alongside emptiness in the preceding clause, suggesting the three gateways are implicitly present across the two sentences.

"The seven noble riches" refers to the seven noble wealths: faith, moral discipline, conscience, consideration for others, learning, generosity, and wisdom. The phrase is kept as rendered since it is a recognized doctrinal set.

"Eating flesh" likely refers to eating meat prohibited under Mahāyāna precepts; the reference to "cutting off the paternal lineage" is somewhat obscure and may be a metaphorical prohibition against destroying the spiritual lineage, though it could also be literal. This is a genuinely uncertain phrase.

The shift to first person — "I who speak the Dharma am never satisfied" — follows the Tibetan closely and represents the speaker identifying with the ideal of Dharma-speaking.

- The phrase rendered "not being wounded by patience" follows the Tibetan literally: patience does not inflict injury on the practitioner, meaning patience leaves no inner wound or residual resentment. Some commentators read this as patience rendering one invulnerable to harm from others; either nuance is defensible.

The "four means of gathering" refers to the four means of drawing beings to the Dharma: generosity, pleasing speech, purposeful action, and harmonious conduct. The Tibetan here gives only the collective term.

The "perfect abandonments" renders the standard Tibetan for the four right efforts or four correct abandonments, a recognized category of the thirty-seven aids to awakening.

- The phrase rendered "following along" translates a term literally meaning "going after" or "consequent movement," which in context likely refers to the path of consequent or subsequent progression — possibly echoing the concept of subsequent attainment or the sequential following of the path. The doctrinal referent is not entirely transparent from context alone.

The pair rendered "prior limit and later limit being wholly uncut" refers to the continuum of existence not being severed at either end — a formulation against both nihilistic annihilationism and eternalism viewed through the lens of temporal extremes.

The phrase rendered "not rendering purposeful activity unsuitable" is a somewhat opaque expression; the Tibetan suggests that the meaning in question does not obstruct or vitiate purposeful action, preserving the compatibility of the ultimate and the conventional.

- The phrase rendered "root of what does not arise" translates a term that may point to the notion that transgressions have no genuine origination — that their very arising is, at the root, a non-arising. This is a subtle doctrinal point consistent with the Mahāyāna understanding that transgressions, like all phenomena, lack inherent origination.

The phrase "free from exhaustion" in the description of the transformed mind renders a term that can also mean "free from cessation" or "free from being used up." The intended sense is that the mind, seen in its true nature, has not been depleted or consumed by the transgression.

- The phrase rendered as "ten thousand bodhisattvas" translates "khri mi skye ba'i chos la bzod pa skyes so," which literally is "ten thousand bodhisattvas gave rise to patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena." The number khri (ten thousand) is the standard reading here.

The passage "all phenomena stand at the edge of conditions" renders the idiomatic phrase "rkyen gyi kha na las pa," meaning something like "under the power of conditions" or "dependent on conditions at their boundary." This is an unusual formulation; the rendering is contextually plausible but the precise nuance is genuinely open.

- The phrase rendered "the mind that continues the lineage of the buddhas" translates a term literally meaning "the arousal of mind that preserves or perpetuates the lineage of the buddhas" — the image is of keeping the buddha-lineage from dying out, a standard Mahāyāna motif.

The phrase "not looking to inner or outer things" renders a Tibetan idiom for non-attachment to one's body and possessions as well as to external wealth — the standard gloss in the commentarial tradition for the bodhisattva's generosity perfection.

The metaphor of "cataracts" for cognitive obscuration is a well-attested classical Buddhist image for the removal of the obscurations to wisdom; the Tibetan term used here carries that sense.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-clause, corresponding to a deliberate continuation in the source text. The passage lists a long series of "precious arousals of the mind" that culminate in the final summary statement about the bodhisattva's unwearying diligence, after which the text transitions to describe what is progressively relinquished as awakening is approached.
- The passage revolves around the fourfold analytical knowledge (Skt. *pratisaṃvid*): of meaning (*artha*), of phenomena (*dharma*), of definitive expression (*nirukti*), and of eloquence (*pratibhāṇa*). The maiden Ratnā's extended analysis maps the arousal of bodhicitta onto each of these four in multiple ways, producing a series of overlapping identifications. The repetition is intentional and structural in the original, not a textual error.

The phrase rendered "the seeing of solitude" for 獨觀 is somewhat condensed in the original; it refers to contemplating aloofness or withdrawal from conceptual elaboration as the mode of phenomenal knowledge — a standard Mahāyāna gloss.

The passage closes mid-sentence in the source, ending with

□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ — rendered as given; the continuation of the passage follows in the next segment.

- Viśvadarśin is a standard rendering of the Tibetan rnam par gzigs, meaning "all-seeing" or "the one who sees all." The name Puṇyavipākaviśuddha is reconstructed from the Tibetan bsod nams kyi rnam par smin pa yongs su dag pa, meaning "he of the completely pure ripening of merit." The passage ends mid-sentence, and the translation preserves this as the text breaks off there. The reference to "eighty-four thousand women" follows the Tibetan literally; some versions read "eighty-four thousand" as a conventional large number rather than a precise count.
- The phrase rendered "takes even seven steps forward" alludes to the traditional image of the bodhisattva's seven steps at birth and, more broadly, to the smallest gesture of entering the path of awakening being immeasurably superior to vast material offerings. The doctrinal point is that generating bodhicitta outweighs any quantity of material worship.

The list "refuge, island, protector" renders three distinct Tibetan terms: skyabs (refuge), gling (island or continent as a place of safety), and dpung gnyen (ally or protector). The rendering is a close doctrinal parallel to standard Mahāyāna litanies of the bodhisattva's role.

- [illegible]

The epithet "བཤམ་པོ་འཇམ་མགས་པོ་" rendered as "Vipaśyin" follows standard identification of this name as the Tathāgata Vipaśyin, the first of the seven buddhas of antiquity. The passage leaves the sentence incomplete at the end, as this is a continuation passage; the translation preserves the open ending accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "the four inexhaustible expressions" translates a reference to four categories of speech or inexhaustible verbal formulas; the precise list is a technical enumeration whose exact identification depends on the broader sūtra context and may vary by recension.

The name Vipaśyin for the Tathāgata is inferred from context and the preceding passage; the Tibetan here reads "Tathāgata Vipaśyin" implicitly through the pronoun reference to the previously named buddha.

- The phrase rendered "humble in weakness" and "humble in miserliness" etc. translates a repeated construction in which "ཇོ་མོ་གློ་བུ་ལོ་" (literally "being lowly" or "being small/diminished") functions as a term for being weak or deficient in a particular fault. The young lady's philosophical point is that the very places of apparent weakness become sources of corresponding strength in a bodhisattva — a deliberately paradoxical formulation. The rendering "humble in" aims to capture this constructive sense of lowness or smallness without implying a deliberate ethical posture, though "small in" or "deficient in" would be equally defensible.

The epithet "གཙུག་པོ་" (literally "foremost of herds" or "bull of the herd") is a classical epithet of the Buddha, here rendered literally in context as "foremost of herds" to preserve the lion-roar imagery that precedes it; some translators render it "supreme bull."

- The phrase rendered "all-pervading path" translates "kun du 'gro ba'i lam," which refers to a path or quality that pervades all vehicles and all phenomena. Some commentators understand this as the all-pervading quality of gnosis itself. The rendering chosen reflects the most consistent reading in context.

- The phrase rendered "takes the position of the supreme bull of the herd" translates a term meaning the foremost or noblest of his kind — a standard Indic epithet for the Buddha's unrivaled standing among those assembled; the image of the bull as leader of a herd is the intended simile.

The final sentence's "obstructive factors" renders a Tibetan term literally meaning "things that cut off" or "interrupting factors" — in context these are hindrances or obstacles to the path; the repetition in the original is deliberate and has been preserved.

- The phrase rendered as "the accumulation of syllables" and "the emptiness of syllables" translates yi ge gsog and yi ge stong pa nyid respectively. These are somewhat technical expressions: yi ge gsog likely refers to words formed by the assembly or clustering of syllables, while yi ge stong pa nyid refers to words that, in some sense, are empty of syllables or lexically sparse. The passage as a whole seems to advocate a non-critical, non-fault-finding attitude toward all forms of verbal expression. The precise nuance of these two terms is uncertain.

The phrase rendered "the meditative absorption of universal manifestation" translates kun du snang ba'i ting nge 'dzin. This may refer to a specific named samādhi in which the bodhisattva's awareness pervades all appearances universally, enabling him to communicate in all languages via dhāraṇī mastery.

- The phrase rendered "noble silence" reflects the idiomatic force of "ārya non-speaking" — the technical noble silence of one who, having abandoned ignoble speech, refrains from empty discourse; this is a recognized ascetic virtue in the Vinaya and sūtra literature rather than a simple personal preference for quiet.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage as given, in the middle of a list of divine beings. This is simply where the supplied Tibetan ends; nothing is missing from the translation.

The term पाल्यमानसः ("perceiving a nurtured one") corresponds to the classical list of eight or more pseudo-selves found in Sanskrit sources (jīva, poṣa, etc.); "nurtured one" renders the sense of something sustained or fostered, a relatively rare member of this list.

The expression "meditative absorption of formations" renders samskāra-samādhi, literally the samādhi of saṃskāras. In context this refers to a specific tantric or sūtric samādhi classification paired with the samādhi of aspiration; the precise doctrinal identity of this dyad is text-specific and may benefit from checking against the Sanskrit or a commentary.

The phrase about not actualizing the nature of reality free from attachment "as a direct perception" reflects the Mahāyāna tension between insight into emptiness and the bodhisattva's vow to remain in saṃsāra for the sake of beings; the bodhisattva refrains from directly realizing nirvāṇa in a way that would cut off his engagement with the world and the accumulation of merit for the Great Vehicle.

The phrase "passing from one to the next" (gcig nas gcig tu brgyud pa) denotes the unbroken continuity of each listed category across the entire sweep of beginningless and endless time for every sentient being, and it applies collectively to all items in the series.

The "sixty-two erroneous views" is a canonical enumeration of wrong views found in the *Brahmajāla Sūtra* and related texts; it is rendered plainly as the text presents it without further

gloss, as the number itself is the salient point.

- The threefold formula toward the end — "inclines toward nirvāṇa, flows into nirvāṇa, and arrives at nirvāṇa" — renders three distinct Tibetan verbs expressing progressive movement toward liberation; the distinction is preserved in translation but the underlying Sanskrit equivalents are not recoverable from context alone.

The phrase rendered "unfailing supernormal cognitions of beings" involves the Tibetan "འདོགས་པར་བློ་བྱིན་པུ་སྐྱོང་།," where "འདོགས་པར་" could mean "of beings" or could function adverbially as "going"; the reading "of beings" is doctrally standard in this context, referring to the supernormal knowledges concerning the range of sentient beings.

- The pair 超勝不可超勝 rendered here as "exalted and not exalted" refers to a mind that has or lacks a superior quality or transcendent dimension, a standard Abhidharma category meaning "surpassable" versus "unsurpassable" or "lofty versus not lofty." This is a recognized pair in mind-classification lists. The rendering "exalted and one that is not" reflects the standard scholastic usage.

The phrase 阿比多羅 rendered as "accompanied by torpor" follows one reading; it can also mean "accompanied by material attachment or sluggishness." Context within this Abhidharma-style enumeration supports "torpor" as the more fitting doctrinal category, though some editors read it as "materiality" or "clinging to substance."

- The phrase rendered "the Array of Powers" translates a meditative absorption whose title suggests an organized marshaling or deployment of spiritual powers; the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain from context alone, but the translation preserves the literal sense faithfully.

The phrase "the dhāraṇī that coils without end" renders the Tibetan for a dhāraṇī described as infinitely spiraling or winding, suggesting its boundless scope; "coils" captures the verb's literal sense.

The closing list — meditative concentration, liberation, meditative absorption, meditative attainment, thorough affliction — is left open as the passage breaks off mid-enumeration; the list likely continues with "thorough purification" as its complementary term, standard in such contexts, but the text as given ends here.

- The compound सुखमयः in the list of wisdom qualities literally suggests something like "flowing softly" or "moving gently and smoothly," which may correspond to a Sanskrit term such as *sūkṣma* or similar. The rendering "flowing gently" is contextually plausible but the exact technical referent is uncertain.

The list of eight non-human and human assembly types follows a standard cosmological enumeration; the parenthetical identifications are provided on first occurrence for the listener's orientation. Dri za (fragrance-eaters) are gandharvas, and nam mkha' lding are the great bird beings (garudas).

- The phrase rendered "the Source of Precious Gems" translates rin po che'i 'byung gnas, which is the name of a specific meditative absorption or samādhi; it likely corresponds to a Sanskrit samādhi name such as Ratnākara or Ratnodbhava. The exact Sanskrit title is not established from this passage alone, but the rendering follows the literal sense.

"The dhāraṇī of the three circles" renders 'khor gsum gyi gzungs. The "three circles" (agent, action, object) is a standard Mahāyāna formula; here the dhāraṇī apparently encompasses or transcends all three, though the precise doctrinal sense depends on the broader text.

The phrase *brnag pa rnyog pa med pa'i gzungs*, rendered "the dhāraṇī free from turbid grasping," uses *brnag pa* in the sense of intent or grasping attention; *rnyog pa* means turbid or

polluted. This compound is somewhat unusual and the rendering is the most natural reading in context.

- The phrase rendered "free from wavering" translates a term meaning something like "without hesitation or unease" and "free from timidity and universal timidity" renders a doubled construction indicating both personal fearlessness and freedom from all forms of alarm — the doubling is emphatic and rhetorical rather than marking two fully distinct states. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source, which is reflected in the translation ending at a natural syntactic pause.
- The phrase rendered "the lion's full extension" translates a dhāraṇī name; the Tibetan "seng ge nam par bsgyings pa" literally means "the lion fully spread out" or "the lion in full stretch," a common epithet for a particular dhāraṇī in this literature. The precise Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain but "Siṃhavijṛmbhita" is the standard equivalent found in related texts.

The passage on the bodhisattva's response to hearing of the future Tathāgatas' wisdom shifts mid-paragraph into a description of what that bodhisattva becomes devoted to; the structure in the Tibetan is cumulative and somewhat loose, and the translation renders it as a continuous enumeration to preserve that quality for listening.

- The phrase rendered "optical illusion" translates mig 'phrul nam par dbye ba, literally "the differentiation of eye-magic or visual illusion," referring to world-realms whose spatial arrangement involves illusory or magical visual proliferation. The exact doctrinal referent is not entirely certain in context, but the general sense of visual or optical marvel is clear.

The closing description — "one who has thoroughly cultivated the meditative absorption of the exceedingly pure and stainless mudrā, and is skilled in the dhāraṇī of the vajra maṇḍala" — appears to describe a qualifying attribute of a Tathāgata who can in principle enumerate all these things, yet even such a one cannot reach the limit of enumeration, underscoring the inexhaustibility of these categories.

- The phrase rendered "with vision in all directions" for "kun nas mig dang ldan pa" is literally "endowed with eyes from all sides" or "possessed of eyes everywhere," a stock phrase indicating omnidirectional awareness; the rendering captures the intended meaning within the doctrinal list.

The compound "rig pa dang / bsnyen bkur byas pa dang / dran pa dang / thos pa don yod pa" presents a brief catalogue: learning (vidyā), service or veneration, mindfulness, and fruitful hearing; these are rendered straightforwardly as individual members of the list.

- The term translated as "the seven prominent features" refers to the traditional enumeration of seven bodily parts that are raised or full: the two hands, two feet, two shoulders, and the trunk of the body — a standard mark in the thirty-two major marks literature.

The antelope name rendered as Airāvata follows a common variant found in Tibetan sources for the deer with beautiful limbs used as a simile; some traditions give a different Sanskrit equivalent. This is a genuine textual uncertainty but does not affect the doctrinal content.

- The term rendered "acceptance of the birthlessness of phenomena" is anutpattikadharmakṣānti, a key Mahāyāna technical attainment signifying the bodhisattva's patient acceptance or direct tolerance of the fact that phenomena do not ultimately arise. The phrase "roar the lion's roar" is a stock Buddhist expression for proclaiming the Dharma with authority and fearlessness, used here to elevate these bodhisattvas to a status parallel to that of the Buddha himself.
- The list form here is a canonical enumeration of virtuous qualities constituting a bodhisattva's practice of Dharma. The Tibetan runs as a long asyndetic list of noun phrases and participial clauses joined by "dang" throughout, which has been rendered as a continuous enumeration. The phrase "ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་མཆོད་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟོས་པ་" literally "without feeling or sensation" in this context most likely

refers to non-reactivity to pleasant sense impressions rather than the absence of the aggregate of feeling, and has been rendered accordingly. The phrase " straightforwardly " is somewhat compressed and has been read as speaking in a manner that is direct and unconcealed, i.e., frank and open speech.

- The term rendered "non-fabrication" throughout translates अप्रवृत्तिनिवृत्तिः, literally "absence of deliberate constructing or compounding." In the *Prajñāpāramitā* and related literature this refers to the absence of volitional or karmic fabrication, a concept closely related to the signless and wishless — the three gateways to liberation. The rendering "non-fabrication" is used here as the most natural English equivalent for a TTS context.

The passage ends mid-list with "Not engaging with the elements," indicating the text continues and has been cut at this point.

- The phrase rendered "one born of semen" and "one who grasps at a seed" (Tibetan: shed las skyes pa and shed bur 'dzin pa) refer to technical categories in the list of designations for a self or living being found in the Pali and Sanskrit Āgama traditions. The rendering follows standard scholastic usage. The full list — self, sentient being, life-force, nourishment, person, individual, and these additional terms — is a recognized canonical enumeration of views about a permanent self.

The phrase "ground or non-ground of the essential nature of self and phenomena" renders a dense series of locatives listing various metaphysical "grounds" (gnas) that one does not engage with; the translation preserves the list structure while keeping prose flow.

- The final verse employs the classical Indian rhetorical device of the sixteenth part, a standard measure of incomparable disproportion found throughout Buddhist and Brahmanical literature, signifying that not even the sixteenth fraction of a unit can match the item being praised.

The phrase rendered "a single taste" reflects the Tibetan *ro gcig*, literally "one flavor" or "one taste," a term with doctrinal resonance in both *sūtra* and *tantra* traditions, referring to the non-differentiated, unified quality of something. In context it describes the unified totality of the merit accumulated.

- The verse phrase rendered "generated through birthlessness" reflects the Tibetan "skye ba med pas bskyed," a deliberate paradox: birthless-ness (anutpāda) is the very generative ground of inexhaustible patience. This is the technical patience of non-arising (anutpāda-kṣānti), and the doctrinal point is that unborn reality is the basis from which genuine patience arises.

The passage "they display their lives, their entering into existence, their passing away, the seat of awakening, the great turning of the wheel of Dharma, and the form of a buddha" describes the non-returns enacting the classic deeds of a buddha (the twelve deeds), which is significant in context: it signals their proximity to full buddhahood.

• The phrase rendered "the māra of the divine son" refers to the Māra who appears as a heavenly being, specifically Devāputramāra, one of the four classical māras alongside the māra of afflictions, the māra of the aggregates, and the māra of the lord of death. The four-māra framework is a standard doctrinal enumeration; no emendation was required.

The clause "this vehicle renders the conditioned realm unconditioned" is a deliberately paradoxical formulation: by attaining the appearance or semblance of the conditioned, the vehicle reveals its unconditioned nature. This is doctrinally intentional and not a textual error.

• The phrase translated as "the third collection" renders "phung po gsum pa," literally "the third heap" or "the third collection," which refers to the Tripiṭaka's Bodhisattva-piṭaka or, in some readings, to a specific repentance and aspiration liturgy (the "three-part practice"). The precise referent here is genuinely uncertain and may depend on a specific liturgical or textual

context not fully determinable from this passage alone.

The passage ends mid-list, as the source text supplied is incomplete at its close.

- The phrase rendered "performing ablutions with one's body face down" translates the Tibetan literally meaning to bathe or wash the body with the face turned downward. This is a somewhat obscure idiom whose precise doctrinal sense in this context — likely referring to a posture of humility or a ritual act of self-purification as a basis for fidelity to one's commitments — is not entirely transparent from the text alone. The connection drawn between this act and stability in one's vow or commitment follows the structure of the surrounding list of paired causes and effects.

- The phrase "Brahmā lord of the Akaṇiṣṭha realm" renders "བླ་མ་ལྷ་མོ་འཁ་ཇི་ཤཱ་ཀ་ལྷ་ཁོང་།," a Brahmā who is described as the lord of the Akaṇiṣṭha heaven, a standard formulation in Mahāyāna sūtras; this is maintained consistently with any prior rendering in the context.

The phrase "patient acceptance of the doctrine of non-arising" renders

"འཇིག་རྟེན་མེད་པའི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་མཐོང་ལྡན་ལྷོ་མཆོག་གི་འཇིག་རྟེན་མེད་པའི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་མཐོང་ལྡན་།," the standard anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the bodhisattva's patient acceptance of the fact that all phenomena are without arising.

- The closing colophon names three figures associated with the great ninth-century translation projects at the Tibetan imperial court: Jinamitra and Dānaśīla were Indian paṇḍitas, and Ye shes sde was one of the most prolific Tibetan lotsāwas of that period. The phrase rendered "the maiden Ratnā" reflects the Tibetan bu mo rin chen, literally "the maiden Precious-one," which appears throughout the text as an interlocutor's name; it could also be understood as the name Ratnaśrī or simply "Precious Maiden," but "Ratnā" is kept consistent with how she has been named in the preceding passages.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.